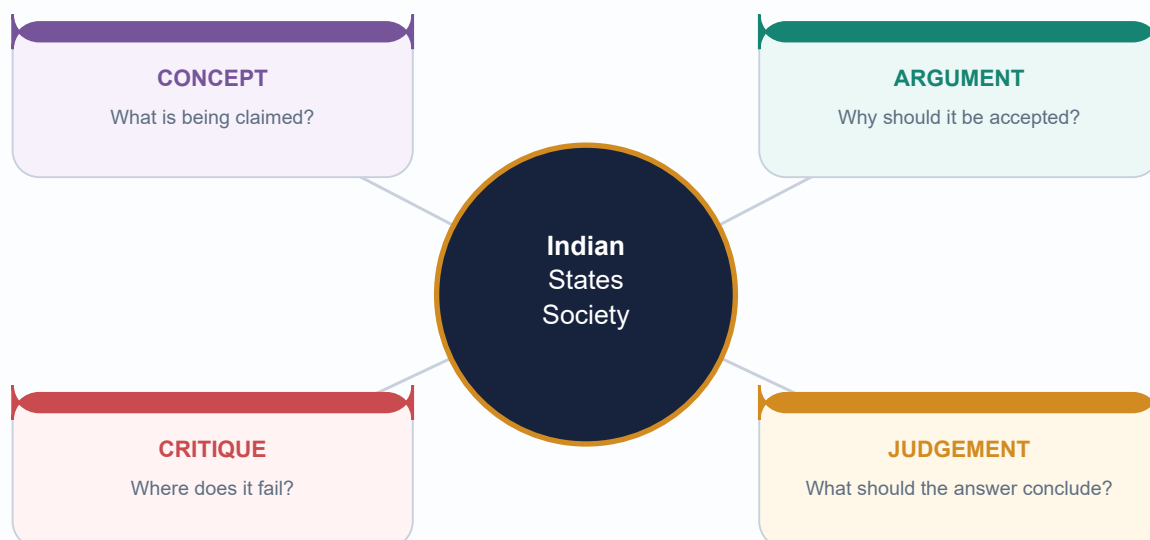


UPSC MODERN INDIAN HISTORY | COMPLETE TOPIC PACKAGE

Indian States & Society in the Eighteenth Century

Modern Indian History Topic 02 | Prelims GS-I + GS-II
Evidence-led regional comparison | Complete teaching + practice
Generated 14 August 2026 | approved=false



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Sources actually used

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

No current-affairs story was forced. The 2025 UNESCO inscription of the Maratha Military Landscapes is used only as a material-heritage bridge. Qdrant was not used because repository Markdown and OCR-searchable local books were sufficient.

KEY DATA

Source class	Exact source	Use and caveat
Repository knowledge	Modern History Topic 02 basic/advanced; README; Master Chronology; Revision Chart; PYQ routing; Answer-Worthiness Audit.	Controls scope, classification, chronology, answer architecture, factual-risk rules and PYQ provenance.
Repository bridge	Rebuilt Modern Topic 01; bounded Modern Topics 03-05; Medieval Topics 23-25 basic/advanced.	Supplies Mughal institutional inheritance, Shivaji legacy, European-company context, conquest boundary, society/economy continuity and Panipat cautions without duplicating later topics.
Local OCR book	Bipan Chandra, *Modern India*, Chapter II.	Foundation survey for successor states, Marathas, Sikhs, Mysore, Travancore, society, economy and culture; broad decline language is regionally qualified.
Local OCR book	Satish Chandra, *Medieval India: From Sultanat to the Mughals, Part II*, especially the Maratha bid for supremacy and eighteenth-century transition.	Detailed control for Peshwa policy, Palkhed, chauth/sardeshmukhi, regional power and Mughal continuity; rhetorical speeches and exact casualty/treasure totals are not repeated.
Local OCR book	Sekhar Bandyopadhyay, *From Plassey to Partition*, Chapter 1.	Main interpretive check for regionalisation, Bengal finance, Hyderabad and Awadh institutions, Sikh social base, military fiscalism, trade and historiography. Quantitative claims are not generalised beyond their region.
Named documentary/material traditions	Farmans, sanads, coins, khutba, seals, revenue records, Persian chronicles, Company factory records, regional correspondence and built heritage.	Used as source families; no uncertain quotation, aggregate income, troop total or casualty figure is asserted.
Official heritage	UNESCO Maratha Military Landscapes; UNESCO Jantar Mantar Jaipur; District Amritsar Gobindgarh Fort; ASI conservation framework.	Bounded material-evidence and conservation links only. Heritage recognition is not treated as proof of a political claim.
Verified PYQ routing	Repository 2021 Prelims Q48/Q45 and 2022 GS-I Q2 route.	Questions are included; locally unavailable official Prelims keys are prominently marked inferred.

STATIC THEORY

- Package practice counts

- 3 verified/routed PYQs; 48 hard MCQs; 12 remedials; 3 each solved 10-, 15- and 20-mark Mains; 17 final register modules.

- Bounded authoritative links

- UNESCO, Maratha Military Landscapes of India: <https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1739/>

- UNESCO, Jantar Mantar, Jaipur: <https://whc.unesco.org/en/list/1338/>

- District Amritsar, Gobindgarh Fort: <https://amritsar.nic.in/tourist-place/gobindgarh-fort/>

- Archaeological Survey of India, Conservation and Preservation: <https://asi.nic.in/pages/Conservation-&-Preservation>

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

01. Scope, periodisation and governing debate

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The eighteenth century was a **transition in the location and social basis of power**, not a uniform transition from order to chaos. Its history must be written region by region and then synthesised, with political crisis separated from commercial, agrarian, social and cultural evidence.

COMPACT VISUAL

NECESSARY BACKGROUND

late-Mughal institutions
Shivaji and Khalsa legacies

CORE FIELD, c. 1707-early 1800s

successor and regional states
-> society, economy, culture, war

BOUNDED CONSEQUENCE

Company conquest after
-> Plassey/Buxar and later wars

Unit of analysis: centre, province, locality, social group and commercial network.
Never treat "India" as one undifferentiated aggregate.

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Phase	Political signature	Exam use
1707-1720	Mughal succession, Shahu-Tarabai conflict, Banda Singh Bahadur, Sayyid politics	inherited crisis and opening
1720s-1740s	Hyderabad, Bengal and Awadh consolidate; Baji Rao expands; Jaipur and Travancore strengthen	regional state formation
1740s-1761	Alivardi's Bengal, Maratha northern bid, Sikh recovery, Afghan pressure	intense interstate competition
1761-1770s	Panipat setback, Maratha recovery, misl power, Mysore consolidation	no decisive all-India successor
late 18th century	Company becomes a fiscal-military contender; Ranjit Singh and Tipu bounded	bridge, not inevitable destination

STATIC THEORY

- Compact scope visual

- Governing thesis

- [FACT] The eighteenth century saw the contraction of Mughal enforceable authority and the multiplication of regional centres. It did not produce an empty political space.

- [CONCEPT] **Political fragmentation** describes divided sovereignty and interstate competition. **Regionalisation** describes the relocation of resources, offices and patronage into durable provincial arenas. **State formation** describes the effort to turn revenue rights, local alliances, military labour and legitimacy into governable territory.

- [THESIS] The most defensible synthesis is: **central imperial decline + regionally varied state-building + continuing Mughal institutional language + uneven economic and social outcomes.**

- [LIMIT] "Dark age" is too total because Bengal commerce, Maratha expansion, Sikh mobilisation, Mysore centralisation, Jaipur science and regional courts show vitality. "Prosperous continuity" is equally unsafe because warfare, revenue farming, Maratha raids, coercive extraction and insecure cultivation imposed serious costs.

- [BOUNDARY] Shivaji and Guru Gobind Singh appear as institutional legacies, not as substitutes for the eighteenth-century story. Ranjit Singh, Tipu Sultan and Company wars are used only where they complete a trajectory.

- Periodisation ladder

- Exam-safe verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

02. Evidence base, source matrix and method

GS-I Modern
Indian History

COMPACT VISUAL

DEFINE LEVEL ->	NAME EVIDENCE ->	STATE WHAT IT PROVES ->	ADD REGION/GENRE LIMIT ->	GRADED VERDICT
centre/province	ruler, record,	mechanism or	no aggregate claim	crisis +
locality/group	coin, site, event	comparison		resilience

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Source family	Named examples or forms	What it can establish	Main limit
Persian chronicles and court histories	Khafi Khan and successor-state court writing	offices, campaigns, factions, ceremony and elite judgement	court-centred, moralising and patronage-shaped
Farmans, sanads and appointment records	1719 Maratha grants; provincial appointments	intended hierarchy, fiscal claims and recognised office	a grant proves a legal claim, not uniform collection
Coins, seals and khutba	emperor's name on coin/Friday sermon; Banda's coin and seal	symbolic sovereignty and public authority	symbol does not measure daily administrative reach
Revenue and banking records	jama, hasil, ijara, peshkash, hundi, mint and treasury relations	fiscal capacity, credit and intermediaries	uneven survival and elite/accounting bias
Company factory records	Bengal, Coromandel and western-coast correspondence	customs disputes, goods, credit, fortification and political risk	corporate perspective and weak inland knowledge
Regional correspondence and memory	Maratha letters/bakhars; Sikh traditions; local genealogies	mobilisation, claims, diplomacy and political memory	retrospective legitimisation and heroic compression
Built and material evidence	forts, observatories, palaces, paintings, textiles, coins, manuscripts	spatial power, technical capacity, patronage and continuity	survival and conservation are selective

STATIC THEORY**- Source matrix****- Method rules**

- [METHOD] Every important claim should run: **claim -> named ruler/institution/event/source/region -> significance -> limitation.**

- [METHOD] A coin or khutba in the emperor's name indicates retained Mughal legitimacy. It does not prove revenue remittance, military obedience or effective provincial supervision.

- [METHOD] A farman for chauth or an appointment as subahdar identifies a legal relationship; actual collection and political independence depended on force and negotiation.

- [METHOD] Court records illuminate elites better than women, labourers, artisans and peasants. Social claims therefore require cautious language and regional variation.

- [METHOD] Company records are unusually detailed on prices, goods and privileges but are interested documents, not neutral descriptions.

- [METHOD] Do not move from one prosperous province to a national growth rate, or from one war-torn corridor to an all-India collapse.

- Source-use flow**- Factual-risk cautions**

- The canonical **twelve Sikh misls** are a later organising shorthand; the number and boundaries of armed-territorial bands were fluid in contemporary evidence.

- Do not quote a fixed Panipat casualty total, Bengal revenue aggregate or Maratha collection total.

- Do not infer women's condition from elite memoirs alone.
- Do not label every successor-state act "independence"; specify formal symbolism and practical autonomy separately.

MAINS ANGLE

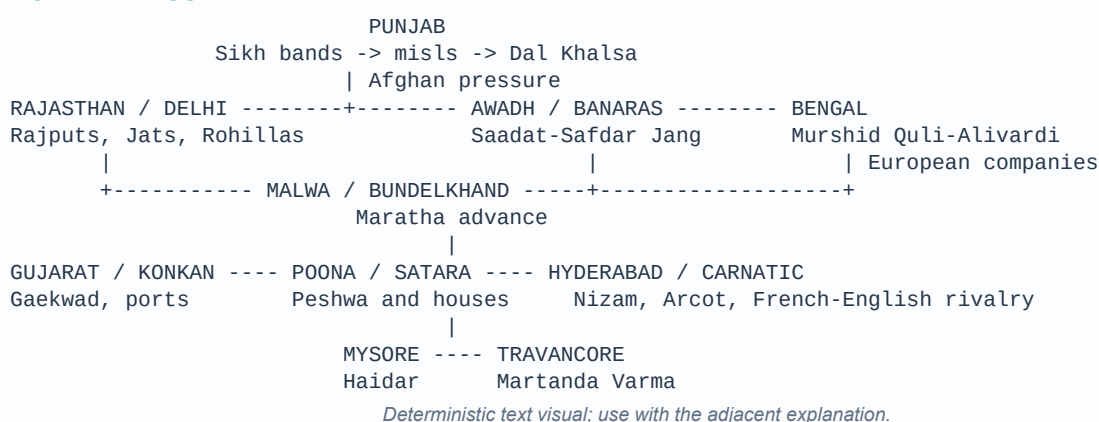
Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**03. Political map after Mughal weakening**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

S-C-I: Successor states inherited office; Confederate powers shared power; Independent/regional kingdoms centralised selectively.

COMPACT VISUAL**KEY DATA**

State type	Legitimacy route	Resource route	Structural tension
Mughal successor	imperial office, title, coin and khutba	provincial revenue, zamindars, bankers	autonomy in practice but borrowed symbolism
Confederacy	negotiated leadership among armed houses	tribute, chauth, sardeshmukhi, local collections	reach versus central command
Misl network	Khalsa identity, conquest shares, collective action	land shares, protection and local revenue	horizontal solidarity versus chiefly consolidation
Centralising regional kingdom	dynasty, conquest, court and ritual	direct assessment, monopoly trade, disciplined army	centralisation versus local elites

STATIC THEORY

- Political map in text

- How to read the map

- [FACT] **Successor states** - Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad - converted Mughal provincial office into hereditary or dynastic autonomy without an immediate formal break.

- [FACT] **Resistance/rebel and confederate states** - Marathas, Sikhs, Jats and Rohillas - grew through armed mobilisation, revenue claims, local solidarities and military labour markets.

- [FACT] **Older autonomous or independent regional kingdoms** - Mysore, Travancore and major Rajput houses - strengthened central authority within pre-existing political fields.

- [ANALYSIS] Categories explain origin and legitimacy, not a fixed hierarchy of success. Mysore could innovate more sharply than a successor state; Bengal could mobilise more commercial wealth than many "independent" kingdoms.

- [LIMIT] Regional boundaries were zones of layered claims, not modern borders. A Maratha right to collect chauth, Mughal appointment, zamindari right and local chief's authority could overlap.

- State comparison matrix

- Memory hook

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

04. State formation engine: fiscal, military, social and financial power

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Merchant support did not mechanically transfer from Mughals to regions or from regions to the Company. Banking houses pursued security, repayment and access; their choices differed by moment and faction.

COMPACT VISUAL

Mughal supervision weakens

- + local elites retain land, fort and caste/community influence
- + warfare raises demand for cash, cavalry, infantry and artillery
- + merchants/bankers move revenue and extend credit

|

v

ruler bargains with zamindars + appoints revenue managers + recruits military labour

|

v

treasury/credit funds army -> army enforces revenue -> revenue rewards clients

|

v

regional court, identity and institutions become durable

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- State-formation flow

- Core mechanisms

- [FACT] **Local elites:** zamindars, deshmukhs, poligars, clan chiefs and landed magnates supplied revenue knowledge, armed retainers and social legitimacy. Few rulers could simply abolish them.

- [FACT] **Revenue farming:** ijara transferred collection to contractors who promised a fixed sum. It produced quick cash but could intensify pressure and strengthen financier-collectors.

- [FACT] **Banking and credit:** hundis, sureties, treasury management and mint access connected land revenue to mobile armies and long-distance trade.

- [FACT] **Military labour:** Afghans, Rajputs, Marathas, Arabs, north Indian infantrymen, European-trained gunners and locally recruited peasant-soldiers moved across courts. Loyalty often followed pay, patronage and command.

- [ANALYSIS] State formation was therefore not "ruler versus society"; it was a negotiated coalition in which rulers tried to centralise without losing the intermediaries who made rule possible.

- Banker-state-company triangle

- VISUAL: BANKER / MERCHANT / credit, remittance, bullion // security, mint access contracts, trade privilege // REGIONAL STATE ----- EUROPEAN COMPANY / customs, revenue ships, factories, armed force / The triangle could finance a state, constrain it, or help a company enter politics.

- Limitation

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

05. Hyderabad: Nizam-ul-Mulk, Mughal continuity and practical autonomy

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim: Hyderabad retained Mughal sovereignty in form while exercising regional sovereignty in substance. **Evidence:** coin and khutba symbolism continued, but Asaf Jah made war, treaties, appointments and mansabs independently.

Significance: this distinguishes legitimacy from enforcement. **Limit:** Hyderabad's post-1748 succession struggles show that practical autonomy was not the same as administrative unity.

KEY DATA

Date/phase	Named evidence	Significance
1722-24	Nizam-ul-Mulk served as wazir, then returned to the Deccan	court frustration redirected an imperial noble toward a regional base
1724	defeat of Mubariz Khan and consolidation as Asaf Jah I	autonomous Hyderabad conventionally dated from this political victory
1720s-1748	wars, treaties, appointments and mansabs made locally	practical sovereignty expanded
after 1748	succession conflict and French intervention	autonomy did not eliminate internal or external vulnerability

STATIC THEORY**- Formation and chronology****- Continuity and autonomy matrix**

- TABLE: Mughal continuity | Practical autonomy | Analytical meaning; coins in emperor's name | Nizam conducted wars and treaties | legitimacy outlived command; emperor named in khutba | major appointments made without reference | ceremonial hierarchy coexisted with regional government; mansab, jagir and Persian chancery vocabulary | hereditary/durable provincial elite | inherited forms changed social content; peshkash and imperial titles | revenue and army served Hyderabad priorities | remittance and obedience became selective

- Institutions and social coalition

- [FACT] Nizam-ul-Mulk subdued refractory zamindars but generally incorporated local rulers and tribute-paying chiefs rather than destroying every indigenous power structure.

- [FACT] Traders, moneylenders, military aristocrats and revenue specialists supplied finance and service. Bandyopadhyay stresses that new men with fiscal expertise rose alongside older military elites.

- [FACT] Revenue farming expanded, jagirs became more hereditary and mansabdari retained only part of its older regulatory content.

- [ANALYSIS] Hyderabad was not a miniature centralised Mughal Empire. It was a patron-client order in which power remained widely diffused beneath the Nizam's supremacy.

- [BOUNDARY] Arcot/Carnatic developed from the Deccan-Hyderabad political hierarchy and then acquired practical autonomy. French-English intervention belongs mainly to Topic 03.

- Claim-evidence-significance-limit**MAINS ANGLE**

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**06. Bengal: revenue, commerce, bankers and the pre-Plassey boundary**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

The topic ends with Siraj-ud-Daula's accession in 1756 and the destabilising factional field around the young Nawab. The 1717 farman, dastak abuse, fortification, Plassey, Buxar and Diwani are fully owned by Topics 03-04.

KEY DATA

Ruler/phase	Named evidence	State-formation significance
Murshid Quli Khan	combined nazim and diwan authority in 1717; revenue survey and strong zamindars	provincial checks weakened; revenue became the base of autonomy
Shuja-ud-din	succession endorsed by Muhammad Shah; cooperation with regional elites	dynastic transfer within continuing imperial sanction
Sarfraz Khan	displaced by Alivardi with support from military, banking and landed interests	the Nawab depended on a coalition, not office alone
Alivardi Khan, 1740-56	appointments made locally; Maratha and Afghan challenges; European trade recovery	practical break deepened without a formal declaration

STATIC THEORY

- Political sequence

- Revenue-commerce-finance system

- [FACT] Murshid Quli Khan enforced punctual revenue through powerful intermediary zamindars, punished refractory holders and converted some jagirs to khalisa. The result was concentration in a smaller number of large landed magnates.

- [FACT] Bengal's cotton and silk textiles, sugar, oil and other goods moved through inland and oceanic routes. European companies brought bullion to purchase Bengal goods, while Indian Hindu, Muslim and Armenian merchants remained important.

- [FACT] Umi Chand and Khoja Wajid illustrate major merchant influence. The house of **Jagat Seth** became provincial treasurer in 1730 and gained strategic connection with the mint and remittance system.

- [ANALYSIS] The Bengal state was a coalition of Nawab, zamindars, officials, merchants and bankers. Its fiscal strength created autonomy, but coalition dependence also gave elites leverage over succession.

- Maratha raids and recovery

- [FACT] Repeated Maratha incursions during Alivardi Khan's reign disrupted life, overland trade and revenue, especially in western Bengal and Orissa.

- [FACT] The 1751 settlement involved the surrender of Orissa and a chauth arrangement. Avoid a single numerical summary of damage or prosperity.

- [ANALYSIS] Recovery through expanding European corporate and private trade shows resilience, but the same expansion increased the companies' political and commercial leverage.

- Pre-Plassey boundary

- Balanced verdict

- Bengal disproves both extremes: it was neither an untouched commercial paradise nor a province already doomed to Company conquest. Its productive and financial networks strengthened regional autonomy, while elite coalition politics and company privilege created contingent vulnerabilities.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

07. Awadh: Saadat Khan, Safdar Jang and a fiscal-military buffer

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Awadh demonstrates **controlled accommodation**: the Nawab centralised revenue and military command but governed through landed chiefs, fiscal officials and mobile allies. It remained formally inside Mughal sovereignty while becoming a self-directed regional power.

KEY DATA

Phase	Named evidence	Significance
1722	Saadat Khan appointed governor; later titled Burhan-ul-Mulk	imperial office became the platform for regional power
1723 onward	fresh revenue settlement and campaigns against refractory zamindars	treasury and military authority reinforced each other
dynastic consolidation	Safdar Jang recognised as deputy/successor	office moved toward hereditary control
1748-53	Safdar Jang also served as imperial wazir	Awadh power and Mughal office remained intertwined

STATIC THEORY**- Formation sequence****- Fiscal and elite structure**

- [FACT] Saadat Khan defeated major zamindars but usually confirmed submitted chiefs in their estates after securing regular payment. This preserved local capacity while asserting Nawabi supremacy.

- [FACT] Bandyopadhyay notes that the provincial diwan and revenue flow were detached from effective imperial supervision, while local gentry received jagirs and a new elite of Indian Muslims, Afghans and Hindus supported the regime.

- [FACT] Awadh's fertile middle-Ganga location, trade and access to north Indian military labour made it a major fiscal-military state and strategic buffer.

- [FACT] Safdar Jang used Maratha and Jat military assistance against Bangash and Rohilla opponents. Alliance followed need, not religious blocs.

- Court, culture and limits

- [FACT] The later shift of courtly gravity toward Lucknow supported handicrafts, literature and a distinctive composite culture; the city became the capital only after the immediate formation phase.

- [LIMIT] Heavy or increased assessment cannot be converted into a province-wide peasant-welfare verdict. Zamindars remained capable of rebellion whenever military pressure weakened.

- [BOUNDARY] Shuja-ud-Daula, Panipat and Buxar appear only to show Awadh's later strategic position; Company subordination and annexation belong to later topics.

- Answer verdict**MAINS ANGLE**

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

08. Maratha legacy before Peshwa expansion: bounded Shivaji, Shahu and Tarabai

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The post-Shivaji order converted a founder-centred kingdom into a negotiated system of **Peshwa authority + royal legitimacy + autonomous sardars + local hereditary rights**.

COMPACT VISUAL

Shivaji's legacy

forts + mobile war + measured revenue + cash-paid core + coronation + chauth claim

|

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post-1680 war and dispersed sardars

|

Tarabai at Kolhapur <-> Shahu at Satara after release in 1707

|

v

Balaji Vishwanath builds a negotiated coalition and strengthens the Peshwaship

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Legacy map

- Bounded legacy

- [FACT] Shivaji's forts, coastal strategy, disciplined mobile forces, coronation at Raigad and administrative practices provided symbols and techniques. They did not predetermine an eighteenth-century centralised empire.

- [FACT] After Rajaram's death, Tarabai led resistance in the name of Shivaji II. Shahu's release in 1707 produced a prolonged contest between Satara and Kolhapur.

- [FACT] Sardars bargained among rival claimants and the Mughals. Their personal followings, watan rights and military resources made them partners, not obedient bureaucrats.

- [FACT] Balaji Vishwanath, appointed Peshwa in 1713, won important sardars to Shahu and increasingly made the Peshwa the functional centre of policy.

- Identity caution

- [LIMIT] "Maratha" identified a changing political and social field, not a homogeneous modern nation. Brahman administrators, Maratha warriors, local deshmukhs, peasants, Muslims, artillery specialists and regional houses occupied unequal positions.

- [LIMIT] Religious language and memories of swarajya mattered, but expansion, revenue, patronage and rivalry explain actual alliances better than a single Hindu-versus-Muslim frame.

- Transition insight

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

09. Peshwa expansion: Balaji Vishwanath, Baji Rao I and Nana Saheb

GS-I Modern
Indian History

KEY DATA

Peshwa	Main political work	Named evidence
Balaji Vishwanath, 1713-20	consolidated Shahu; converted Mughal crisis into recognised fiscal claims	1719 imperial sanads; Delhi expedition with Sayyids
Baji Rao I, 1720-40	shifted from defence toward systematic expansion	Palkhed 1728; Malwa and Gujarat; Delhi raid 1737; Bhopal settlement
Balaji Baji Rao/Nana Saheb, 1740-61	widened reach and made Poona the effective centre after Shahu	Bengal raids; 1752 imperial protection; Udgir 1760; Panipat 1761

STATIC THEORY

- Three-Peshwa chronology

- Balaji Vishwanath and the 1719 settlement

- [FACT] The Mughal grants recognised Shahu's swarajya and claims to chauth and sardeshmukhi in six Deccan provinces, alongside obligations of service and tribute.

- [ANALYSIS] The settlement used imperial legality to legitimise Maratha extraction. It was neither full Mughal submission nor a modern declaration of independence.

- [FACT] Collection responsibility was distributed among sardars who retained much of the proceeds for troops and expenses. This expanded power quickly but reduced direct central control.

- Baji Rao I

- [FACT] Baji Rao made the hereditary Peshwaship the focal point of the political system through battlefield success and patronage.

- [FACT] At **Palkhed (1728)** he forced Nizam-ul-Mulk to reaffirm Shahu's Deccan claims; the settlement did not establish permanent Maratha mastery over all southern politics.

- [FACT] Malwa and Gujarat offered resources and strategic depth against Hyderabad and Delhi. Maratha claims moved from tribute to spheres of influence and, in some zones, territorial administration.

- [LIMIT] Rhetorical speeches attributed to Baji Rao in later accounts cannot be treated as verbatim policy documents.

- Nana Saheb

- [FACT] After Shahu's death in 1749, the Peshwa became the effective head and Poona the working capital.

- [FACT] Expansion reached Bengal, the Deccan, Rajasthan, Delhi and Punjab, but durable administration was strongest in selected areas such as parts of Malwa, Gujarat and Khandesh.

- [ANALYSIS] Wide military reach exceeded institutional integration. That gap is central to understanding Panipat and later confederate politics.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

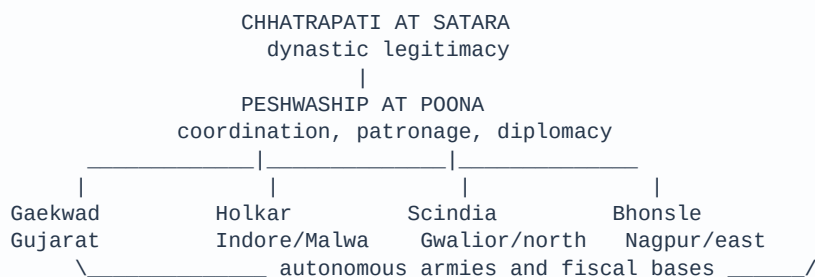
Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

10. Maratha confederacy, revenue and administration

GS-I Modern
Indian History

COMPACT VISUAL



Not a unitary state: authority overlapped with local zamindars, vatandars and tribute payers.

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Term	Exam-safe meaning	Trap
chauth	claim commonly framed as one-fourth of assessed revenue from territory outside the core	not an ordinary village land tax and not automatic sovereignty
sardeshmukhi	additional one-tenth claim based on asserted superior deshमुख right	not another word for chauth
watan	hereditary local office/right and its emoluments	could survive centralising rulers
saranjam	assignment supporting military service, comparable in some ways to jagir	not private property in the modern sense
kamavisdar/mamlatdar	civilian revenue functionaries in expanding Maratha administration	terminology and practice varied by region

STATIC THEORY

- Confederacy diagram

- Fiscal terminology

- Administrative structure

- [FACT] In core territories, the Peshwas developed a more regular civilian revenue administration. Outside the core, tribute collection and negotiated rights often preceded direct administration.

- [FACT] Maratha civilian revenue specialists, many of them Brahmans, could remain distinct from military command, unlike the more unified Mughal civilian-military mansab structure.

- [FACT] Sardars used personal armies and fiscal spheres. The same arrangement rewarded initiative and enabled Gaekwad, Holkar, Scindia and Bhonsle houses to consolidate regional bases.

- [ANALYSIS] Confederacy was not simply "weakness": it reduced the cost of rapid expansion and permitted regional entrepreneurship. Its cost was strategic rivalry, uneven remittance and limited unified command.

- Maratha-state debate

- [INTERPRETATION] Irfan Habib highlights a zamindar/agrarian revolt dimension; Satish Chandra stresses regional power and Deccan supremacy; Andre Wink emphasises Maratha operation within a broader Mughal idiom of layered rights.

- [VERDICT] The Maratha order combined rebellion, Mughal legal language, regional identity and new confederate power. No one label exhausts it.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

11. Panipat 1761 and post-Panipat recovery

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Panipat was a severe **strategic and demographic shock**, not a civilisational verdict or terminal date. Its deepest lesson is that territorial reach without a trusted coalition and secure logistics could not produce stable paramouncy.

COMPACT VISUAL

Maratha protection of Mughal court and advance into Punjab

- + Ahmad Shah Abdali's repeated intervention
- + Rohilla support and Shuja-ud-Daula's strategic choice
- + Maratha alienation of Rajput, Jat and some Sikh allies
- + long supply line and divided command

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Third Battle of Panipat
14 January 1761

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

It did	It did not
destroy an experienced northern expeditionary force and damage Peshwa prestige	end Maratha power everywhere
check the immediate bid for north Indian supremacy	create stable Afghan rule in India
expose the cost of thin alliances and long logistics	make British conquest automatic
create room for other powers, including the Company, to consolidate	erase later Maratha recovery

STATIC THEORY**- Road to Panipat****- Battlefield and political explanation**

- [FACT] Sadashiv Rao Bhau held actual command; Vishwas Rao represented the Peshwa's house; Ibrahim Khan Gardi commanded European-trained infantry and artillery.

- [FACT] Abdali allied with Najib-ud-Daula and gained Shuja-ud-Daula's support. Maratha relations with Rajputs, Jats and Sikh chiefs had been damaged by tribute demands and interference.

- [ANALYSIS] Defeat arose from diplomacy, supply, coalition management and command as much as battlefield technique. It does not prove that Indian armies were inherently incapable of disciplined infantry or artillery.

- [LIMIT] Avoid fixed casualty figures. Sources and later narratives vary, and exam value lies in political consequences.

- What Panipat did and did not do**- Recovery**

- [FACT] Peshwa Madhav Rao I (1761-72) defeated the Nizam, pressured Haidar Ali and restored influence in north India.

- [FACT] In 1771 Maratha forces restored Shah Alam II to Delhi, demonstrating recovered reach.

- [BOUNDARY] Mahadji Scindia and Nana Fadnavis later sustained Maratha power, but the Anglo-Maratha wars belong to Topic 05.

- Verdict**MAINS ANGLE**

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**12. Sikh state formation I: Khalsa legacy and Banda Singh Bahadur**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Later heroic traditions preserve indispensable memory but may compress motives, numbers and unanimity. The safest answer names the institutions Banda created and then qualifies the uneven social coalition.

KEY DATA

Phase	Named evidence	Significance
1699	Guru Gobind Singh establishes the Khalsa	visible discipline, initiation and armed community
1708	Guru's death; authority vested in Panth and Granth traditions	end of personal Guruship
1709-15	Banda Singh Bahadur mobilises in Punjab	revolt becomes territorial and administrative
1715-16	capture and execution	centralised phase defeated, not the community

STATIC THEORY**- Chronology and social base****- Khalsa legacy**

- [FACT] The Khalsa strengthened a distinctive collective identity through initiation, the five visible symbols and the legitimacy of armed defence.

- [LIMIT] Not all Sikhs immediately became Khalsa, and the community included Jat peasants, Khatri traders, artisans and other groups with different interests.

- [ANALYSIS] Political identity emerged through institution, ritual, agrarian conflict and warfare; it should not be reduced to persecution alone.

- Banda Singh Bahadur

- [FACT] Banda's main support included Jat peasants and smaller zamindars under severe fiscal pressure, though support was never uniform.

- [FACT] In territories under his influence he appointed faujdars, a diwan and kardars, used a seal and minted coin. These are state-making acts, not only rebellion.

- [FACT] Khatri commercial interests could favour stability and Mughal revenue farming, while oppressive ijaradars could drive other groups toward Banda. Sikh society was internally differentiated.

- [ANALYSIS] The movement linked social challenge to political sovereignty, but its administrative reach and duration were limited by Mughal military pressure and internal division.

- Source and chronology caution**MAINS ANGLE**

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

13. Sikh state formation II: misls, Dal Khalsa and bounded Ranjit Singh

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Sikh state formation moved from **Khalsa discipline** -> **Banda's territorial administration** -> **decentralised misl sovereignty** -> **selective collective action** -> **late monarchical consolidation**. The path was neither linear nor socially homogeneous.

COMPACT VISUAL

```

local fighting bands and territorial shares
    | kinship, comradeship, conquest contribution
    v
MISLS with chiefs and pattis
    \      |      /
    \ collective need /
    DAL KHALSA
joint mobilisation against major threats
    |
recurrent assembly / collective resolution
    |
late-century pressure toward chiefly and monarchical consolidation
    
```

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Misl network visual

- Organisation

- [FACT] After Banda's execution, Sikh bands survived persecution and used the disruption caused by Nadir Shah and Ahmad Shah Abdali to expand.

- [FACT] Territory captured by a misl could be distributed among members according to contribution, giving even lower-ranking soldiers a patti or share.

- [FACT] The **Dal Khalsa** supplied a level of collective mobilisation above individual misls. Collective assemblies and resolutions did not eliminate chiefly autonomy.

- [SOURCE CAUTION] Textbooks often list **twelve major misls**; Bandyopadhyay notes a much more fluid field of territorial combinations in the 1770s. Write "twelve major misls in the conventional classification" rather than treating the map as timeless.

- [ANALYSIS] The misl order combined horizontal co-sharing with an emerging hierarchy of powerful chiefs. Equality was an organising ideal, not a permanent description of property and command.

- Bounded Ranjit Singh

- [FACT] Ranjit Singh of the Sukerchakia misl captured Lahore in 1799 and represents the later shift toward a more centralised Punjab kingdom.

- [BOUNDARY] His European-trained army, 1809 Treaty of Amritsar and later conquests belong mainly to Topic 05. Here he appears only as the outcome of late-century consolidation.

- [MATERIAL LINK] District Amritsar identifies Gobindgarh Fort's sequence from Bhangi Misl to Ranjit Singh, Company and Indian Army. The site illustrates layered political use; it does not by itself prove the structure of every misl.

- Verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

14. Mysore: Wodeyar inheritance, Haidar Ali and military fiscalism

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Mysore had less need to borrow Mughal provincial legitimacy and therefore experimented more openly with direct taxation, military organisation and, under Tipu, symbols of sovereignty. Yet it remained an early-modern state constrained by war, technology, local elites and limited resources.

COMPACT VISUAL

survey and classification of land

- > cash/direct collection through salaried officials
- > reduced intermediary share in selected zones
- > larger treasury
- > infantry, artillery, arsenals and long war
- > pressure for still more revenue

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Political genealogy

- [FACT] Mysore emerged from the political field of Vijayanagara and retained a Wodeyar king even when ministers and later Haidar Ali exercised effective power.

- [FACT] Haidar rose through the army, established a modern arsenal at Dindigul in 1755 with French assistance and took effective control in 1761.

- [FACT] He subordinated poligars, expanded territory and organised more disciplined infantry and artillery while continuing to use cavalry and local structures.

- Military-fiscal system

- [INTERPRETATION] Burton Stein's phrase **military fiscalism** captures the direct connection between resource mobilisation and a large central army.

- [FACT] Mysore did not abolish every jagir or local right, but it tried more systematically than many states to reduce the independent power of hereditary intermediaries.

- [BOUNDARY] Tipu Sultan's coinage, khutba, state trading corporation, sericulture, navy and wars show the later extension of this project. His detailed conflict with the Company belongs to Topic 05.

- Comparison with successor states

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

15. Travancore and Kerala: centralisation, trade and regional culture

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Travancore resembles Mysore in army building and intermediary control, but differs in its stronger dependence on pepper and coastal commerce and in its location outside formal Mughal provincial succession.

KEY DATA

Instrument	Named evidence	Significance
military centralisation	western-trained army and modern weapons	subordinated feudatories and rival principalities
territorial expansion	Quilon and neighbouring territories; Dutch power checked	created a larger southern kingdom
commercial policy	royal monopoly over pepper and wider coastal trade	trade revenue strengthened the state
public works	irrigation, roads and canals	linked fiscal power with communication and cultivation

STATIC THEORY

- State-building under Martanda Varma

- [FACT] Travancore rose after 1729 under Martanda Varma, suppressed major local chiefs and defeated Dutch political power in Kerala.

- [FACT] By the 1760s the Kerala political field was increasingly dominated by Travancore, Cochin and Calicut before Mysorean intervention in the north.

- [ANALYSIS] Royal trade was not wholly unprecedented; Mughal princes and nobles had long participated in commerce. Travancore's distinctiveness lay in the scale and systematic use of monopoly revenue for central power.

- [FACT] Trivandrum became a centre of Sanskrit scholarship, music and Malayalam literary revival under Martanda Varma and Rama Varma.

- [LIMIT] Court-centred literary vitality does not establish broad literacy or equal access. Nair dominance and regional social hierarchy remained important.

- Exam comparison

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

16. Jats, Rajputs, Rohillas, Arcot and other regional states

GS-I Modern
Indian History

KEY DATA

Power	Formation logic	Named evidence	Limit
Jats of Bharatpur	peasant-zamindar mobilisation into a kingdom	Churaman, Badan Singh, Suraj Mal (1756-63)	state retained strong zamindari and fiscal hierarchy
Rajput states	older clan polities loosened Mughal ties	Sawai Jai Singh II; Jaipur; provincial governorships	rivalry prevented a single Rajput bloc
Rohillas	Afghan military settlement and north Indian labour market	Ali Muhammad Khan; Rohilkhand	pressured by Awadh, Marathas and later Company
Farrukhabad	Afghan military household	Ahmad Khan Bangash	limited territorial depth
Arcot/Carnatic	Deccan subordination followed by Nawabi autonomy	Nizamat of Arcot emerged from Hyderabad field	succession wars opened European intervention

STATIC THEORY

- Comparative matrix

- Jats

- [FACT] Jat mobilisation around Mathura and Agra began through agrarian and zamindari resistance. Churaman and Badan Singh created Bharatpur; Suraj Mal expanded and centralised it.

- [FACT] Suraj Mal used Mughal-style revenue practices and tried to reduce dependence on overmighty kinsmen. Peasant origin did not make the state socially egalitarian.

- Rajputs and science

- [FACT] Rajput houses gained provincial office and autonomy but continued inter-house and lineage rivalry. They were not a united nationalist front.

- [FACT] Sawai Jai Singh II founded Jaipur in 1727 and built observatories. UNESCO describes Jantar Mantar as an early-eighteenth-century meeting point of scientific cultures and royal authority.

- [LIMIT] One scholarly ruler does not prove a general scientific revolution; it does disprove an undifferentiated claim of cultural sterility.

- Rohillas and the military labour market

- [FACT] Afghan soldiers and commanders moved through north India's military labour market. Rohilkhand and Farrukhabad were products of migration, service and Mughal weakening.

- [ANALYSIS] Their careers show that ethnicity could organise military networks without creating a stable modern nation-state.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim → named evidence → significance → limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

17. Society: elites, zamindars, peasants, caste, women and military labour

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Society combined rigid status structures with selective mobility. Political fragmentation opened careers for soldiers, bankers and local elites but did not amount to broad social emancipation.

KEY DATA

Group	Role in the political economy	Evidence-safe qualification
ruling elites	courts, jagirs, military households, patronage	luxury and austerity both existed; avoid a universal decadence claim
zamindars/deshmukhs/poligars	revenue mediation, forts, armed followings, caste/clan leadership	ranged from small intermediaries to major rajas
peasants	cultivation, revenue base, recruitment and revolt	internally differentiated; costs varied by crop, tenure and war zone
merchants/bankers	credit, remittance, mint, treasury and supply	could support rulers, factions or companies according to interest
artisans	textiles, arms, shipbuilding, luxury and everyday goods	fortunes depended on region, market and patronage
military labour	cavalry, infantry, artillery and retainers across courts	identity and loyalty were shaped by pay, kin and patronage

STATIC THEORY

- Society matrix

- Social hierarchy and mobility

- [FACT] Caste and jati remained powerful, with regional rules over marriage, dining, occupation and honour. Political service could nevertheless raise individuals and lineages, as illustrated by the Holkar family's ascent.

- [FACT] Muslim society was also stratified by status, lineage, sect and occupation. Political alliances rarely followed a simple Hindu-Muslim divide.

- [ANALYSIS] Eighteenth-century state formation created mobility for military and fiscal specialists while reproducing hierarchy for most cultivators and labourers.

- Women: evidence and limits

- [FACT] Elite women could exercise dynastic, financial and patronage influence; Tarabai and Ahilyabai Holkar are visible examples. Peasant and poorer women worked in cultivation, craft and household production.

- [FACT] Purdah, early marriage, restrictions on widow remarriage and sati varied sharply by class, caste and region. Kerala's matrilineal practices and more common widow remarriage among some non-elite groups prevent a single model.

- [LIMIT] Court and colonial observers disproportionately record elite women and spectacular customs. Silence about ordinary work is not proof of inactivity; visibility is not proof of equality.

- Balanced verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

18. Economy: agriculture, crafts, towns, merchants, bankers and trade

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The economy was **resilient, commercialised and regionally unequal**, while political-military competition could be predatory. Neither aggregate collapse nor aggregate prosperity is supported by the surviving evidence.

KEY DATA

Sector	Evidence of vitality	Evidence of crisis/limit
agriculture	reclamation and surplus in parts of Bengal, Awadh-Banaras and the south	revenue pressure, war, flight and unequal tenure
textiles/crafts	Dacca, Murshidabad, Patna, Surat, Ahmedabad, Banaras, Lucknow, Masulipatnam and other centres	court decline and warfare damaged particular towns and artisan groups
inland trade	hundis, caravans, merchant networks and regional markets	extra customs posts, robbery and contested routes
oceanic trade	European bullion and demand for textiles; Indian, Armenian and Muslim merchants	companies gained coercive privilege and political leverage
finance	Jagat Seth, treasury management, surety and credit	financier influence could narrow a ruler's room for action

STATIC THEORY

- Regional economy table

- Agriculture and revenue

- [FACT] Agriculture remained the main source of state income. Zamindars, jagirdars, ijaradars and state officials competed over surplus, and the burden ultimately fell heavily on cultivators.

- [ANALYSIS] Older accounts stress technical stagnation; revisionist studies stress monetisation, reclamation and regional surplus. The correct answer separates productivity from welfare: output could grow while the cultivator's security worsened.

- Crafts and towns

- [FACT] Cotton and silk textiles, saltpetre, indigo, sugar, arms, metalwork, shipbuilding and luxury crafts remained important. Indian ships and artisans continued to serve Asian and European demand.

- [FACT] Delhi, Lahore, Mathura, Surat and other centres suffered episodes of plunder, but Murshidabad, Lucknow, Banaras, Hyderabad, Poona, Jaipur and southern centres gained new patronage or commercial roles.

- [VERDICT] Urban change was a **redistribution of patronage and risk**, not one national curve.

- Merchants, bankers and companies

- [FACT] Indigenous bankers transferred credit through hundis and guaranteed revenue contracts. Banking houses did not merely lend; they connected treasuries, mints, merchants and armies.

- [FACT] European companies entered existing Indian Ocean and inland commercial systems. Their ships, fortified factories and state-backed violence later gave them unusual coercive leverage.

- [LIMIT] Do not convert Bengal's favourable trade balance or one banker's political role into a claim that all merchants welcomed Company power.

- Economy verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

19. Culture, language, art, science and regional courts

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The UNESCO Maratha forts, Jantar Mantar and restored Gobindgarh Fort help students visualise defence networks, scientific patronage and layered reuse. Conservation evidence proves survival and present management, not the full historical meaning of the sites.

COMPACT VISUAL

contraction of Delhi's exclusive dominance

↓
artists, scholars, soldiers and administrators move

↓
Murshidabad - Lucknow - Hyderabad/Arcot - Jaipur - Poona - Punjab - Travancore

↓
new regional styles within continuing Persianate and vernacular worlds

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

STATIC THEORY

- Patronage shift

- Cultural evidence

- [FACT] Urdu poetry and prose expanded in north Indian urban settings; Persian remained important in administration and elite culture; Marathi, Punjabi, Bengali, Braj and Malayalam traditions continued in distinct regional contexts.

- [FACT] Mughal painters and musicians moved toward regional courts. Kangra and other Rajput painting traditions developed vitality; music flourished under Muhammad Shah and later patrons.

- [FACT] Lucknow's court supported literature, performance and handicrafts; Hyderabad and Arcot sustained Deccani-Persianate and Sufi traditions; Travancore supported Malayalam and Sanskrit scholarship.

- [FACT] Jaipur's planned city and Jantar Mantar demonstrate interaction between political authority, urban design and astronomy.

- Composite culture with qualification

- [FACT] Hindu and Muslim elites frequently served the same rulers, participated in shared linguistic worlds and formed cross-religious alliances. Firangi Mahal in Lucknow, Vaishnava patronage in Bengal and the Sringeri relationship with Tipu illustrate diverse court-religion relations.

- [LIMIT] "Composite culture" should not erase caste, sectarian tension, elite control of literacy or unequal access to patronage.

- [LIMIT] Cultural vitality at court cannot be used as a direct proxy for mass welfare.

- Heritage bridge

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

20. Warfare, fiscal-military change and diplomacy

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century war was not simply cavalry raiding versus European science. It was competition among different fiscal-military coalitions, one of which - the Company - gradually combined oceanic supply, corporate credit and territorial revenue more consistently.

COMPACT VISUAL

revenue + credit + tribute

|

v

cavalry / infantry / artillery / forts / supply

|

v

conquest or protection -> new revenue rights

|

v

stronger army OR overextension, debt and rebellious intermediaries

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Power	Military signature	Financial base	Main constraint
Hyderabad	Deccan cavalry, mansabdari remnants, client chiefs	land revenue, peshkash, financiers	diffused power and succession
Bengal	limited standing force relative to fiscal wealth	rich revenue, commerce and bankers	underinvestment in coercive capacity and company fortification
Awadh	cavalry, artillery, zamindari and hired allies	fertile revenue and trade	refractory chiefs and multi-front pressure
Marathas	mobile cavalry plus growing infantry/artillery	chauth, sardeshmukhi, tribute and regional bases	confederate rivalry and long logistics
Sikh misls	mobile bands, fort and territorial shares	local land, protection and conquest shares	decentralised command
Mysore	drilled infantry, artillery, arsenal and direct revenue	survey, cash collection and state trade	continuous coalition war

STATIC THEORY**- Fiscal-military loop****- Military comparison****- Diplomacy**

- [FACT] Alliances cut across religion: Safdar Jang hired Maratha and Jat aid; the Nizam alternately fought and bargained with Marathas; Abdali allied with Rohillas and Awadh; Indian rulers used French and English forces.

- [ANALYSIS] Diplomacy was an instrument of fiscal survival. A ruler sought an ally not only for battle but to secure revenue districts, trade routes and legitimacy.

- [FACT] European-trained units were not an exclusively European possession: Ibrahim Khan Gardi and Mysore's forces show Indian adaptation. The Company's later advantage lay in cumulative finance, supply, naval support and integrated command.

- [LIMIT] "Military modernisation" was uneven. Importing drill or officers did not create a domestic industrial base or remove factional politics.

- Answer insight**MAINS ANGLE**

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**21. Continuity and innovation in Mughal institutions****GS-I Modern
Indian History****INTRO & ORIGIN**

The century's institutional signature was **continuity of grammar, change of authorship**.

COMPACT VISUAL**MUGHAL FORM**

subah / nazim / diwan
mansab / jagir
Persian chancery
coin and khutba
zamindar mediation
revenue remittance

REGIONAL ADAPTATION

-> offices combined or made hereditary
-> localised, hereditary or selectively retained
-> regional court administration
-> symbolic legitimacy despite autonomy
-> stronger landed magnates and negotiated rule
-> provincial treasury, banker and army priority

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Evidence	Strong conclusion	Unsafe conclusion
emperor's name on coin	ruler sought Mughal legitimacy	Delhi controlled local revenue
khutba in emperor's name	public ceremonial hierarchy continued	province lacked practical autonomy
imperial sanad	claim received legal recognition	claim was collected everywhere
local appointment without reference	effective autonomy expanded	modern national sovereignty existed

STATIC THEORY

- Mughal-continuity flow

- Continuities

- [FACT] Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad retained Persian administrative vocabulary, land-revenue practices, elite service and imperial symbols.

- [FACT] Maratha administration in Malwa, Gujarat and Khandesh often retained Mughal terminology and local intermediaries.

- [FACT] Sikh and Mysore administrations also used inherited territorial and revenue practices where useful, even while changing political identity.

- Innovations

- [FACT] Combining nazim and diwan in Bengal concentrated provincial power; Hyderabad expanded hereditary patron-client relations; Maratha confederacy distributed fiscal-military spheres; Sikh misls institutionalised conquest shares; Mysore pushed more direct cash assessment and disciplined units.

- [ANALYSIS] Innovation usually altered **who controlled an old form**, not always the vocabulary of the form itself.

- [LIMIT] The survival of an institution's name does not prove unchanged function. A hereditary Hyderabad jagir and a transferable high-Mughal jagir were not identical.

- Symbolism test

- Verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

22. Historiography: dark age, material crisis, regionalisation and economic revision

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The debate is partly about **scale**. Delhi chronicles reveal imperial contraction; provincial revenue and commercial records reveal regional resources; village-level evidence reveals unequal social costs. Different sources can all be true at different levels.

KEY DATA

Approach	Main proposition	Named scholars/lineage	What it explains	Main criticism
imperial decline/dark age	weak rulers, faction, invasion and moral/political disorder produced anarchy	older imperial and nationalist narratives; Jadunath Sarkar often associated with ruler-policy emphasis	central collapse, war and court failure	generalises Delhi's crisis to all regions and can moralise
Aligarh/materialist	jagirdari-agrarian contradiction, surplus pressure, peasant-zamindar resistance and fiscal crisis	Irfan Habib; Satish Chandra's jagirdari and structural work	links political failure to revenue and social relations	crisis evidence and mechanism varied by region
regional/Cambridge-influenced	local elites, portfolio capital, commercial networks and provincial coalitions shifted power outward	C.A. Bayly; Muzaffar Alam; Richard Barnett; regional studies	explains why provinces could be dynamic as centre weakened	can understate imperial cohesion, coercion and agrarian cost
revisionist economic	production, trade, credit and urban networks remained resilient in many zones	regional economic histories; Bayly and others	corrects blanket stagnation and identifies new wealth	regional evidence cannot prove all-India prosperity
institutional synthesis	Mughal forms persisted while content and social coalitions changed	Sekhar Bandyopadhyay's balanced synthesis; Richard Eaton and others regionally	joins continuity, innovation and culture	requires careful state-by-state evidence

STATIC THEORY**- Historiographical debate****- Fair representation**

- [INTERPRETATION] Materialist work is not merely "decline history": it explains why revenue pressure and intermediary conflict could destabilise an empire.

- [INTERPRETATION] Regional revision is not a "golden age" claim: it demonstrates local growth, commercialisation and state formation while accepting coercion and uneven welfare.

- [INTERPRETATION] Cambridge-style attention to elites and networks should not erase peasants, artisans or violence; agrarian crisis should not erase merchant credit and regional prosperity.

- Source-critical synthesis**- Best UPSC line**

- "The eighteenth century was a crisis of Mughal centralisation, a transition in fiscal and political authority, and a period of selective regional resurgence; none of these descriptions is sufficient alone."

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

23. Crisis, transition or regional resurgence - graded synthesis

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The century was **not one national experience**. "Crisis" best describes imperial command and war-affected corridors; "transition" best describes institutions; "regional resurgence" best describes selected states, markets and cultures. A high-scoring answer combines all three and states where each applies.

COMPACT VISUAL

DEFINE the label and scale

- > POLITICAL evidence
- > ECONOMIC/SOCIAL counter-evidence
- > REGIONAL comparison
- > SOURCE/HISTORIOGRAPHY limit
- > GRADED verdict

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Label	Evidence for it	Evidence against using it alone
crisis	war, raids, revenue pressure, Delhi's weakness, route insecurity, peasant burdens	Bengal, Awadh, Mysore, Jaipur and regional courts retained capacity
transition	Mughal forms survived while offices, revenue and armies became regional	"transition" can sound painless and hide coercion
regional resurgence	new courts, armies, commercial networks and identities flourished	resurgence was socially unequal and not universal

STATIC THEORY

- Three-verdict matrix

- Weighted synthesis

- **Political level:** crisis and fragmentation are strongest. No regional power created uncontested all-India paramountcy.

- **Institutional level:** transition is strongest. Mughal offices, fiscal vocabulary, Persian culture and symbolic sovereignty were repurposed.

- **Economic level:** regional variation is strongest. Some commercial and agrarian zones expanded; war corridors and taxed cultivators suffered.

- **Social level:** continuity of hierarchy dominates, with selective mobility for soldiers, officials, bankers and new ruling houses.

- **Cultural level:** regional resurgence is persuasive, though concentrated around courts, towns and literate networks.

- Answer framework

- Final verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

24. Bridge to colonial conquest without inevitability

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century fragmentation created **opportunity**, not destiny. Colonial conquest required later victories, Bengal's revenue, corporate-military integration, Indian collaboration and repeated failures of anti-Company coalition.

COMPACT VISUAL

interstate rivalry + succession disputes + mobile military labour
+ banker/merchant credit
+ European fortified factories and navies

|

v

companies can sell troops, finance factions and demand privileges

|

Bengal revenue after 1765 + integrated command + maritime supply

|

v

Company becomes a territorial fiscal-military state

Deterministic text visual; use with the adjacent explanation.

KEY DATA

Date	Bridge significance
1740s-60s	European companies participate in regional succession and war
1757	Plassey gives political leverage in Bengal
1764-65	Buxar and Diwani create a durable revenue base
later 18th century	Company wars use revenue, alliance and credit against Indian states

STATIC THEORY

- Opportunity structure

- How regional politics created openings

- [FACT] Carnatic and Hyderabad succession disputes enabled French and English intervention. Bengal's commercial privileges and fortifications brought a company into conflict with a Nawab.

- [FACT] Rulers and elites used companies as allies, creditors or military contractors; companies did not initially stand outside Indian politics.

- [FACT] Merchant-bankers, Indian sepoys, artillerymen, revenue officials and local allies were indispensable to Company expansion.

- [ANALYSIS] The Company differed not because it lacked Indian dependence, but because it linked Indian resources to a corporate command, oceanic supply and British state power.

- Why conquest was not inevitable

- Mysore defeated Company forces and forced the Treaty of Mangalore in a later phase.

- The First Anglo-Maratha War ended in the negotiated Treaty of Salbai.

- Ranjit Singh's Punjab remained independent during his lifetime.

- Panipat did not immediately produce British supremacy outside Bengal.

- Bounded timeline

- Verdict

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

25. Terminology, timeline, memory hooks, traps and answer toolkit

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Claim -> named ruler/institution/revenue measure/banker/event/region/source -> what it proves -> limitation -> reasoned conclusion.

KEY DATA

Date	Event	Recall value
1699	Khalsa founded	Sikh institutional legacy
1707	Aurangzeb dies; Shahu released	imperial and Maratha transition
1708	Guru Gobind Singh dies	Banda phase follows
1713	Balaji Vishwanath becomes Peshwa	Peshwa consolidation
1715-16	Banda captured and executed	centralised Sikh revolt checked
1717	Murshid Quli Khan combines Bengal offices	successor-state consolidation
1719	Maratha sanads and Delhi intervention	Mughal legality + Maratha power
1722	Saadat Khan in Awadh	Awadh formation
1724	Hyderabad under Asaf Jah I	Deccan successor state
1728	Palkhed	Baji Rao defeats Nizam's strategy
1729 onward	Martanda Varma	Travancore centralisation
1740	Baji Rao dies; Alivardi takes Bengal	shift in two regions
1749	Shahu dies	Peshwa becomes effective head
1751	Bengal-Maratha settlement	Orissa/chauth context
1752	Maratha protection of Mughal court	northern reach
1761	Panipat; Haidar's effective Mysore control	setback and southern consolidation
1771	Shah Alam II restored to Delhi by Marathas	post-Panipat recovery
1799	Ranjit Singh captures Lahore; Tipu dies	later boundary

STATIC THEORY

- Timeline ladder

- Terminology bank

- TABLE: Term | One-line definition; nazim/subahdar | provincial executive-military governor; diwan | revenue and fiscal officer/department; peshkash | tribute/payment acknowledging superior authority; ijara/ijaradari | revenue-farming contract; hundi | credit/remittance instrument; chauth | Maratha one-fourth fiscal claim, usually outside the core; sardeshmukhi | additional one-tenth Maratha claim; watan | hereditary local office/right; saranjam | revenue assignment supporting service; misl | Sikh armed-territorial association/confederate unit; Dal Khalsa | collective Sikh military-political formation above individual misls; fiscal-military state | polity that converts revenue and credit into sustained military capacity

- Memory hooks

- **H-B-A:** Hyderabad = hierarchy retained, Bengal = bankers and revenue, Awadh = accommodation with zamindars.

- **B-B-N-M:** Balaji Vishwanath -> Baji Rao -> Nana Saheb -> Madhav Rao.

- **K-B-M-R:** Khalsa -> Banda -> misls -> Ranjit Singh.

- **C-T-R:** Crisis at centre -> transition of institutions -> regional resurgence in selected zones.

- High-frequency traps

- Do not call Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad formally sovereign nation-states.

- Do not describe chauth and sardeshmukhi as the same tax or as automatic territorial rule.

- Do not end Maratha history at Panipat.

- Do not begin Sikh political history with Ranjit Singh.

- Do not call Mysore a Mughal successor state.

- Do not turn one region's prosperity or devastation into an all-India aggregate.

- Do not make eighteenth-century alliances communal by default.

- Do not make Company conquest inevitable from Mughal decline.

- Mark-scaled answer architecture

- TABLE: Marks | Structure | Evidence density; 10 | direct thesis -> 3 analytical units -> one qualification -> verdict | 2-3 precise examples; 15 | thesis -> classification/mechanism -> comparison -> society/economy or source limit -> verdict | 4-6 examples; 20 | thesis -> state typology -> fiscal-military/social/economic analysis -> regional comparison -> historiography -> colonial bridge -> graded verdict | 5-8 examples

- Universal answer spine

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

PYQ 01 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q48: eighteenth-century successor statesGS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN****Verified question:** With reference to Indian history, which of the following statements is/are correct?**STATIC THEORY**

- 1. The Nizamat of Arcot emerged out of Hyderabad State.
- 2. The Mysore Kingdom emerged out of Vijayanagara Empire.
- 3. Rohilkhand Kingdom was formed out of the territories occupied by Ahmad Shah Durrani.

- A. 1 only
- B. 1 and 2 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 3 only

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** B, 1 and 2 only. **Confidence:** high.

- Solved explanation

- Statement 1 is correct in the conventional political genealogy: the Carnatic or Nizamat of Arcot developed within the Deccan-Hyderabad hierarchy before its Nawabs gained practical autonomy.
- Statement 2 is correct: the Wodeyar kingdom of Mysore grew from the political field of the Vijayanagara Empire.
- Statement 3 is incorrect: Rohilkhand grew from Afghan military settlement and weakening Mughal authority; Ahmad Shah Durrani later allied with Rohilla power but did not create the state from occupied territory.
- The question tests origin, not merely chronology. It distinguishes successor/subordinate formations from a later invader's sphere.
- **Why this earns marks:** It tests each statement independently, names the predecessor polity, corrects the backward projection of Durrani and labels the answer as inferred because the local official key is unavailable.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

PYQ 02 - 2021 Prelims GS-I Q45: Mughal administrative hierarchyGS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Verified question: With reference to medieval India, which one of the following is the correct sequence in ascending order in terms of size?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Pargana - Sarkar - Suba
- B. Sarkar - Pargana - Suba
- C. Suba - Sarkar - Pargana
- D. Pargana - Suba - Sarkar

- **INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED LOCALLY:** A, Pargana - Sarkar - Suba. **Confidence:** high.

- **Solved explanation**

- A pargana grouped villages and was the smaller revenue-administrative unit in this sequence.
- A sarkar grouped parganas.
- A subah was the larger province containing sarkars.
- The hierarchy matters for Topic 02 because regional states usually appropriated Mughal territorial and fiscal machinery rather than creating administration from nothing.
- **Why this earns marks:** It gives the exact ascending sequence and links the recall fact to institutional continuity, the analytical core of successor-state formation.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**PYQ 03 - 2022 GS-I Mains Q2: Company armies and Indian rulers**GS-I Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Verified adjacent question: Why did the armies of the British East India Company - mostly comprising Indian soldiers - win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons. (10 marks, 150 words)

STATIC THEORY

- **Routing note:** The direct owner is Modern History Topic 05. It is included here because Topic 02 explains the multi-state fiscal-military field from which the Company emerged. The answer must not treat fragmentation as automatic defeat.

- Model answer

- The Company's advantage lay less in the ethnicity of its soldiers than in the organisation that made them a reliable fiscal-military force. Indian states possessed capable cavalry, artillery and revenue systems: Mysore created French-trained infantry, Ibrahim Khan Gardi served the Marathas, and Ranjit Singh later built a disciplined army. The issue was consistency.

- The Company combined regular drill, infantry-artillery coordination, unified command and reliable payment. Coastal bases and the British naval network sustained supply. London credit and Indian bankers financed long campaigns, while diplomacy isolated opponents: Mysore, Maratha and Sikh forces were usually fought in separate wars with Indian allies on the Company side. After **Plassey (1757)** and especially the **Diwani (1765)**, Bengal revenue funded troops and further conquest.

- Yet victory was contingent: Haidar Ali reached Madras, the Treaty of Mangalore was negotiated, the First Anglo-Maratha War ended at Salbai, and Punjab remained independent under Ranjit Singh. The decisive edge was the cumulative integration of command, credit, revenue, supply and alliance, not inherent European superiority.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers "why" through linked mechanisms, uses named counter-evidence, distinguishes capability from identity and ends with a qualified causal verdict.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

PYQ coverage conclusion

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

The audited repository routes one directly relevant successor-state Prelims question and one administrative-inheritance question. No direct GS-I Mains question confined to eighteenth-century regional states appears in the audited 2018-2025 route. The verified 2022 Company-armies question is therefore included only as an explicitly bounded bridge. No History Optional or unofficial coaching question is presented as a UPSC PYQ.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 01

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which classification best describes Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad in the eighteenth century?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Mughal successor states formed from provincial office
- B. Independent kingdoms outside Mughal institutions
- C. European client states from inception
- D. Uniform peasant republics
- **Answer:** A. Mughal successor states formed from provincial office
- **Explanation:** Their founders converted Mughal governorship and revenue office into practical autonomy while retaining imperial forms.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**Hard MCQ 02****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Question: Which evidence most directly shows practical autonomy without a formal break in Hyderabad?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A modern written constitution
- B. Independent war and appointments alongside coin and khutba in the emperor's name
- C. A permanent end to Mughal titles
- D. A ban on Persian administration
- **Answer:** B. Independent war and appointments alongside coin and khutba in the emperor's name
- **Explanation:** The contrast between autonomous action and retained symbolism is the defining evidence.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 03

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Nizam of Arcot is best placed in which political genealogy?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A Rohilla state created by Durrani
- B. A Sikh misl on the Coromandel
- C. A Carnatic formation emerging from the Hyderabad-Deccan hierarchy
- D. A direct Portuguese province
- **Answer:** C. A Carnatic formation emerging from the Hyderabad-Deccan hierarchy
- **Explanation:** Arcot belonged to the Carnatic political field under Hyderabad before gaining practical autonomy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 04

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What does the emperor's name on a regional ruler's coin safely establish?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Daily fiscal control from Delhi
- B. Absence of a regional army
- C. Modern federal subordination
- D. A claim to Mughal legitimacy
- **Answer:** D. A claim to Mughal legitimacy
- **Explanation:** Coin legend is strong symbolic evidence but cannot by itself prove effective administration or remittance.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 05

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Who founded the autonomous Asaf Jahi line conventionally dated from 1724?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I
- B. Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk
- C. Murshid Quli Khan
- D. Alivardi Khan
- **Answer:** A. Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I

- **Explanation:** Nizam-ul-Mulk defeated Mubariz Khan and consolidated Hyderabad in 1724.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 06

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What was institutionally unusual about Murshid Quli Khan's position in Bengal in 1717?

STATIC THEORY

- A. He abolished land revenue
- B. He combined the offices of nazim and diwan
- C. He became Mughal emperor
- D. He transferred Bengal to Awadh
- **Answer:** B. He combined the offices of nazim and diwan

- **Explanation:** Combining executive and fiscal office weakened the older provincial check and strengthened autonomy.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 07

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why was the house of Jagat Seth politically important in Bengal?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It commanded the Maratha confederacy
- B. It administered the Sikh misls
- C. It linked treasury, remittance, credit and mint influence
- D. It founded the Wodeyar dynasty
- **Answer:** C. It linked treasury, remittance, credit and mint influence
- **Explanation:** Banking power supported revenue remittance and coalition politics and later influenced succession.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 08

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which sequence correctly describes Bengal before Plassey?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Alivardi Khan - Murshid Quli Khan - Saadat Khan - Siraj
- B. Saadat Khan - Safdar Jang - Alivardi Khan - Mir Qasim
- C. Nizam-ul-Mulk - Sarfaraz Khan - Shuja-ud-Daula - Siraj
- D. Murshid Quli Khan - Shuja-ud-din - Alivardi Khan - Siraj-ud-Daula
- **Answer:** D. Murshid Quli Khan - Shuja-ud-din - Alivardi Khan - Siraj-ud-Daula
- **Explanation:** The sequence keeps Bengal's dynastic and military transitions distinct from Awadh and Hyderabad.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 09

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Who founded Awadh's autonomous provincial line after appointment as governor in 1722?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk

- B. Safdar Jang

- C. Shuja-ud-Daula

- D. Najib-ud-Daula

- **Answer:** A. Saadat Khan Burhan-ul-Mulk

- **Explanation:** Safdar Jang was Saadat Khan's successor and later imperial wazir.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 10

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which description best captures Awadh's treatment of major zamindars under Saadat Khan?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Universal dispossession and direct peasant ownership

- B. Military submission followed by confirmation when dues were accepted

- C. Complete zamindar independence

- D. Replacement by European collectors

- **Answer:** B. Military submission followed by confirmation when dues were accepted

- **Explanation:** Awadh centralised through controlled accommodation, not total abolition of local landed power.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 11

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: In Maratha fiscal language, chauth was primarily

STATIC THEORY

- A. a ten-percent superior deshmukh claim
- B. a village irrigation cess
- C. a one-fourth claim on assessed revenue, often outside the core territory
- D. a fixed salary to the Peshwa
- **Answer:** C. a one-fourth claim on assessed revenue, often outside the core territory
- **Explanation:** Chauth and sardeshmukhi were distinct claims and did not automatically equal direct sovereignty.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 12

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Sardeshmukhi is best distinguished from chauth as

STATIC THEORY

- A. the Mughal land survey
- B. a Sikh protection payment
- C. a European customs pass
- D. an additional one-tenth claim based on asserted superior deshmukh right
- **Answer:** D. an additional one-tenth claim based on asserted superior deshmukh right
- **Explanation:** The one-tenth sardeshmukhi claim was additional to the one-fourth chauth claim.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 13

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What was the main significance of the 1719 Mughal-Maratha arrangement?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It used imperial sanction to recognise Shahu's swarajya and fiscal claims
- B. It abolished the Peshwaship
- C. It ended Maratha expansion permanently
- D. It transferred Delhi to Hyderabad
- **Answer:** A. It used imperial sanction to recognise Shahu's swarajya and fiscal claims
- **Explanation:** The arrangement joined Mughal legal form to expanding Maratha power and obligations.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 14

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Battle of Palkhed (1728) is associated with

STATIC THEORY

- A. Abdali defeating the Marathas
- B. Bajji Rao I compelling Nizam-ul-Mulk to reaffirm Shahu's Deccan claims
- C. Alivardi defeating the Company
- D. Haidar Ali defeating the Dutch
- **Answer:** B. Bajji Rao I compelling Nizam-ul-Mulk to reaffirm Shahu's Deccan claims
- **Explanation:** Palkhed strengthened Bajji Rao and Shahu but did not settle all Deccan rivalry.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 15

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which pairing of Maratha house and regional base is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Holkar - Bengal
- B. Scindia - Travancore
- C. Gaekwad - Baroda/Gujarat
- D. Bhonsle - Arcot

- **Answer:** C. Gaekwad - Baroda/Gujarat

- **Explanation:** Holkar centred on Indore/Malwa, Scindia on Gwalior/north India and Bhonsle on Nagpur/eastward expansion.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 16

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Baji Rao I's expansion into Malwa and Gujarat was strategically important because it

STATIC THEORY

- A. ended the need for revenue collection
- B. created a unitary national state
- C. removed all local zamindars
- D. provided resources and placed pressure between Hyderabad and Delhi

- **Answer:** D. provided resources and placed pressure between Hyderabad and Delhi

- **Explanation:** The provinces offered wealth, routes and strategic depth; local rights and negotiation remained.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 17

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which power was an important ally of Ahmad Shah Abdali at Panipat?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Najib-ud-Daula of Rohilkhand
- B. Suraj Mal as a committed Maratha commander
- C. Murshid Quli Khan
- D. Martanda Varma

- **Answer:** A. Najib-ud-Daula of Rohilkhand

- **Explanation:** Abdali's coalition included Rohilla support and Shuja-ud-Daula; Maratha relations with likely northern allies had deteriorated.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 18

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The most accurate assessment of Panipat (1761) is that it

STATIC THEORY

- A. created permanent Afghan rule in India
- B. severely damaged Maratha northern power but did not end Maratha recovery
- C. immediately established Company rule across India
- D. abolished the Peshwaship

- **Answer:** B. severely damaged Maratha northern power but did not end Maratha recovery

- **Explanation:** Madhav Rao restored power and Marathas returned Shah Alam II to Delhi in 1771.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 19

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which event best demonstrates post-Panipat Maratha recovery?

STATIC THEORY

- A. The 1717 Bengal appointment
- B. The execution of Banda in 1716
- C. Restoration of Shah Alam II to Delhi in 1771
- D. The founding of Jaipur in 1727
- **Answer:** C. Restoration of Shah Alam II to Delhi in 1771
- **Explanation:** The 1771 action shows renewed northern reach under the recovered confederacy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 20

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why is the Shahu-Tarabai contest important?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It was a British annexation dispute
- B. It created the Khalsa
- C. It ended local hereditary rights
- D. It enabled sardars and the Peshwa to bargain and reshape Maratha authority
- **Answer:** D. It enabled sardars and the Peshwa to bargain and reshape Maratha authority
- **Explanation:** The contest weakened simple dynastic command and helped produce a negotiated Peshwa-centred order.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 21

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Khalsa was established by Guru Gobind Singh in

STATIC THEORY

- A. 1699

- B. 1707

- C. 1719

- D. 1761

- **Answer:** A. 1699

- **Explanation:** The 1699 foundation is the institutional legacy for eighteenth-century Sikh mobilisation.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 22

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which act most clearly shows Banda Singh Bahadur moving from revolt toward state formation?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Joining the English Company

- B. Appointing officials and using coin and seal

- C. Accepting the Peshwaship

- D. Founding Hyderabad

- **Answer:** B. Appointing officials and using coin and seal

- **Explanation:** Faujdars, diwan, kardars, coin and seal are administrative and sovereign practices.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 23

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about Banda Singh Bahadur's social base is most accurate?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Every Khatri merchant supported him
- B. Only Mughal nobles supported him
- C. It included Jat peasants and smaller zamindars but was not socially unanimous
- D. It had no agrarian dimension
- **Answer:** C. It included Jat peasants and smaller zamindars but was not socially unanimous
- **Explanation:** Peasant, zamindar and commercial interests varied, and some groups aligned with the Mughals.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 24

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: How should the number of Sikh misls be written in an evidence-disciplined answer?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Exactly twelve unchanging units from 1699
- B. No misls existed before 1809
- C. All bands were provinces of Awadh
- D. Twelve major misls in conventional classification, with fluid contemporary groupings
- **Answer:** D. Twelve major misls in conventional classification, with fluid contemporary groupings
- **Explanation:** The textbook twelve is useful, but boundaries and the count of territorial combinations changed over time.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 25

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Dal Khalsa represented

STATIC THEORY

- A. collective Sikh mobilisation above individual misls
- B. the Bengal treasury
- C. the Mughal revenue ministry
- D. the Maratha royal council

- **Answer:** A. collective Sikh mobilisation above individual misls

- **Explanation:** It allowed joint action without eliminating misl autonomy.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 26

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why is Ranjit Singh bounded in this topic?

STATIC THEORY

- A. He founded the Khalsa in 1699
- B. He represents late-century consolidation after the misl phase
- C. He fought at Panipat in 1761
- D. He created Rohilkhand

- **Answer:** B. He represents late-century consolidation after the misl phase

- **Explanation:** His capture of Lahore in 1799 completes a trajectory; his mature state and Anglo-Sikh context belong later.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 27

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The Mysore kingdom's historical genealogy is most closely linked to

STATIC THEORY

- A. the Durrani Empire
- B. the Sikh misls
- C. the Vijayanagara political order
- D. the Portuguese Estado da India
- **Answer:** C. the Vijayanagara political order
- **Explanation:** The Wodeyar kingdom emerged from the post-Vijayanagara regional field.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 28

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which reform is associated with Haidar Ali's military consolidation?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Abolition of all land taxes
- B. Creation of the Jagat Seth bank
- C. The 1719 Maratha sanad
- D. A modern arsenal at Dindigul with French assistance
- **Answer:** D. A modern arsenal at Dindigul with French assistance
- **Explanation:** The Dindigul arsenal and trained units strengthened Mysore's military capability.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 29

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Tipu Sultan's later use of his own name in coinage and khutba most strongly indicates

STATIC THEORY

- A. a sharper assertion of sovereignty than most successor states
- B. direct Mughal control
- C. membership in the Dal Khalsa
- D. submission to the Peshwa

- **Answer:** A. a sharper assertion of sovereignty than most successor states

- **Explanation:** The symbolism marked a more explicit claim, though even Tipu used Mughal authority pragmatically when useful.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 30

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Martanda Varma strengthened Travancore mainly through

STATIC THEORY

- A. Mughal mansabdari alone
- B. military centralisation, trade monopoly and public works
- C. Sikh conquest shares
- D. Company Diwani

- **Answer:** B. military centralisation, trade monopoly and public works

- **Explanation:** Army reform, suppression of feudatories, pepper revenue and communication works reinforced the state.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 31

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Who consolidated the Jat kingdom of Bharatpur at its eighteenth-century height?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Churaman alone

- B. Najib-ud-Daula

- C. Suraj Mal

- D. Nizam Ali Khan

- **Answer:** C. Suraj Mal

- **Explanation:** Churaman and Badan Singh built the state; Suraj Mal expanded and centralised it.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 32

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Sawai Jai Singh II is correctly associated with

STATIC THEORY

- A. the Bhangi misl

- B. Murshidabad's mint

- C. the Treaty of Mangalore

- D. Jaipur and monumental astronomical observatories

- **Answer:** D. Jaipur and monumental astronomical observatories

- **Explanation:** Jaipur and Jantar Mantar provide a counter-example to blanket cultural or scientific sterility.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 33

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Rohilkhand emerged primarily from

STATIC THEORY

- A. Afghan military settlement amid Mughal weakening

- B. territory occupied and granted by Durrani

- C. a Portuguese coastal factory

- D. a Travancore succession

- **Answer:** A. Afghan military settlement amid Mughal weakening

- **Explanation:** Durrani later allied with Rohillas; he did not found their state.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 34

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The phrase military labour market refers to

STATIC THEORY

- A. a permanent caste with one ruler only

- B. mobile soldiers and commanders offering service across competing courts

- C. European troops alone

- D. unpaid village police

- **Answer:** B. mobile soldiers and commanders offering service across competing courts

- **Explanation:** Afghans, Rajputs, Marathas, artillerymen and others moved through service networks shaped by pay and patronage.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 35

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Ijara or ijaradari was

STATIC THEORY

- A. a Sikh initiation rite
- B. a Mughal coin legend
- C. revenue farming to a contractor for a fixed promised sum
- D. a Maratha fort category
- **Answer:** C. revenue farming to a contractor for a fixed promised sum
- **Explanation:** It supplied quick cash but could intensify extraction and empower financier-collectors.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 36

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Peshkash most commonly denoted

STATIC THEORY

- A. a village share of chauth
- B. an artillery drill
- C. a European sea pass
- D. tribute or payment acknowledging a superior authority
- **Answer:** D. tribute or payment acknowledging a superior authority
- **Explanation:** Peshkash could preserve a hierarchical relationship without direct daily administration.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 37

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What is the most accurate description of the banker-state-company relationship?

STATIC THEORY

- A. A shifting triangle of credit, security, trade privilege and political leverage
- B. Bankers always served the Company
- C. States did not need credit
- D. Companies had no Indian partners
- **Answer:** A. A shifting triangle of credit, security, trade privilege and political leverage
- **Explanation:** Bankers pursued repayment and access; their alignments varied by region and political moment.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 38

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: A hundi was important because it

STATIC THEORY

- A. served as a fort cannon
- B. transferred credit and remittance across commercial networks
- C. abolished customs
- D. defined a Sikh misl
- **Answer:** B. transferred credit and remittance across commercial networks
- **Explanation:** Hundis helped move revenue, settle accounts and finance trade and war.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 39

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which set contains important eighteenth-century textile or craft centres?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Panipat battlefield, Palkhed, Karnal and Plassey
- B. Lahore fort, Raigad, Arcot and Rohilkhand only
- C. Dacca, Murshidabad, Banaras and Masulipatnam
- D. Anandpur, Satara, Kabul and Mangalore only

- **Answer:** C. Dacca, Murshidabad, Banaras and Masulipatnam

- **Explanation:** Manufacturing centres were distributed across several commercial regions.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 40

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What happened to Bengal's trade under Maratha pressure and European expansion?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All trade ended permanently
- B. Only inland trade grew
- C. European companies withdrew
- D. Some overland trade suffered while oceanic European trade expanded

- **Answer:** D. Some overland trade suffered while oceanic European trade expanded

- **Explanation:** The divergent routes illustrate why one aggregate decline claim is unsafe.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 41

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement best captures caste and mobility in the century?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Hierarchy remained strong, but service could raise selected individuals and lineages
- B. Caste disappeared under regional states
- C. No social mobility existed
- D. Political power always followed ritual rank
- **Answer:** A. Hierarchy remained strong, but service could raise selected individuals and lineages
- **Explanation:** The rise of houses such as Holkar shows mobility within, not abolition of, hierarchy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 42

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Why must women's history be written with explicit source limits?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Women left no historical evidence at all
- B. Elite and spectacular practices are over-recorded relative to ordinary labour
- C. All regions followed one matrilineal system
- D. Court chronicles provide full village data
- **Answer:** B. Elite and spectacular practices are over-recorded relative to ordinary labour
- **Explanation:** Tarabai and Ahilyabai are visible, but ordinary agricultural and craft work is less fully documented.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 43

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about eighteenth-century political alliances is most accurate?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Hindus and Muslims never allied
- B. All wars were religious
- C. Revenue, strategy and faction usually mattered more than communal blocs
- D. Only Europeans crossed religious lines
- **Answer:** C. Revenue, strategy and faction usually mattered more than communal blocs
- **Explanation:** Awadh-Maratha-Jat cooperation and Abdali's alliance with Rohillas and Awadh demonstrate cross-religious strategy.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 44

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: The migration of artists from Delhi to regional courts best supports which argument?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All Mughal art ended in 1707
- B. Regional culture had no Persianate influence
- C. Only European art survived
- D. Patronage was redistributed rather than uniformly extinguished
- **Answer:** D. Patronage was redistributed rather than uniformly extinguished
- **Explanation:** Regional schools and courts gained talent as the imperial centre lost exclusivity.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 45

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which phrase best describes institutional change in successor states?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Continuity of grammar, change of authorship

- B. Complete administrative invention

- C. Unchanged direct rule from Delhi

- D. Modern federalism

- **Answer:** A. Continuity of grammar, change of authorship

- **Explanation:** Old vocabulary and forms survived while regional rulers, elites and financiers controlled them.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 46

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which is a genuine institutional innovation of the century?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Abolition of all intermediaries everywhere

- B. Misl conquest shares and selective direct revenue systems in Mysore

- C. The disappearance of coinage

- D. Uniform parliamentary government

- **Answer:** B. Misl conquest shares and selective direct revenue systems in Mysore

- **Explanation:** Regional states adapted old systems and introduced new coalition or collection mechanisms.

- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 47

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: A fiscal-military state is one that

STATIC THEORY

- A. separates taxation from war completely
- B. depends only on ritual authority
- C. turns revenue and credit into sustained military capacity
- D. has no merchants or officials
- **Answer:** C. turns revenue and credit into sustained military capacity
- **Explanation:** The revenue-army-revenue loop is central to Mysore, Awadh, Maratha and Company power.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Hard MCQ 48

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which factor most clearly distinguished the Company's later fiscal-military system?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Exclusive use of European soldiers
- B. Absence of Indian bankers
- C. No reliance on alliances
- D. Integration of territorial revenue, corporate credit, unified command and maritime supply
- **Answer:** D. Integration of territorial revenue, corporate credit, unified command and maritime supply
- **Explanation:** The Company relied heavily on Indian sepoys, credit and allies but integrated them through a durable corporate-state structure.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 49

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about Panipat is the correct remedial rule?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It checked a northern bid but Maratha power recovered
- B. It ended all Maratha states
- C. It made Abdali emperor of India
- D. It immediately gave the Company the Deccan
- **Answer:** A. It checked a northern bid but Maratha power recovered
- **Explanation:** Never use Panipat as the terminal date of Maratha political power.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 50

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about successor-state sovereignty is correct?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Every governor issued a declaration of national independence
- B. Practical independence could coexist with Mughal coin, khutba and titles
- C. Mughal symbols prove full Delhi control
- D. All successor states abolished Persian
- **Answer:** B. Practical independence could coexist with Mughal coin, khutba and titles
- **Explanation:** Separate formal symbolism from effective appointments, revenue and war.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 51

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which is the correct chauth trap correction?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It was identical to sardeshmukhi
- B. It was paid only by Maratha peasants
- C. It was a fiscal claim, not ordinary direct land tax or automatic territorial rule
- D. It was a Sikh protection tax
- **Answer:** C. It was a fiscal claim, not ordinary direct land tax or automatic territorial rule
- **Explanation:** The nature and collection of the claim varied and often preceded administration.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 52

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which sequence corrects the common Sikh chronology trap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Ranjit Singh - Khalsa - Banda - misls
- B. Banda - Guru Nanak - Ranjit - Khalsa
- C. Misls - Khalsa - Banda - Guru Gobind Singh
- D. Khalsa - Banda Singh Bahadur - misls - Ranjit Singh
- **Answer:** D. Khalsa - Banda Singh Bahadur - misls - Ranjit Singh
- **Explanation:** Do not begin Sikh political history with Ranjit Singh.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 53

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which classification correction is essential for Mysore?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It was an older southern regional kingdom, not a Mughal successor province
- B. It emerged from Rohilkhand
- C. It was a Maratha house
- D. It was created by the Company
- **Answer:** A. It was an older southern regional kingdom, not a Mughal successor province
- **Explanation:** Mysore's genealogy runs through Vijayanagara and the Wodeyars.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 54

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Can Bengal's commercial strength prove all-India prosperity?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Yes; one surplus province fixes the national trend
- B. No; regional evidence requires regional conclusions
- C. Yes; war therefore had no cost
- D. No; because Bengal had no trade
- **Answer:** B. No; regional evidence requires regional conclusions
- **Explanation:** The correct method is regional comparison, not aggregate projection.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 55

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement about Jagat Seth is safest?

STATIC THEORY

- A. It founded the East India Company
 - B. It commanded Abdali's army
 - C. The banking house served regional fiscal power and pursued its interests; it was not a timeless Company agent
 - D. It had no relation to the Bengal treasury
- **Answer:** C. The banking house served regional fiscal power and pursued its interests; it was not a timeless Company agent
- **Explanation:** Banking alignments changed with security, repayment and factional politics.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 56

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: What is the correct coin-and-khutba inference?

STATIC THEORY

- A. They give exact revenue totals
 - B. They prove a ruler had no army
 - C. They prove national sovereignty
 - D. They show legitimacy claims, not the full reach of administration
- **Answer:** D. They show legitimacy claims, not the full reach of administration
- **Explanation:** Symbolic evidence must be paired with appointments, remittance, war and treaties.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 57

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects the 'Maratha nation' overstatement?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Maratha power was socially and regionally diverse and confederate
- B. Every chief obeyed one central bureaucracy
- C. Religion alone determined alliances
- D. Local watan rights disappeared
- **Answer:** A. Maratha power was socially and regionally diverse and confederate
- **Explanation:** Use polity, confederacy and regional mobilisation rather than modern national homogeneity.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 58

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects a uniform claim about women?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Purdah was identical across India
- B. Class, caste, labour and region produced sharply different experiences
- C. All widows could remarry
- D. Elite rulers represent all women
- **Answer:** B. Class, caste, labour and region produced sharply different experiences
- **Explanation:** State the source base and distinguish elite visibility from ordinary work.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 59

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects the 'trade collapse' trap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. All internal and external trade stopped
- B. No artisan centre survived
- C. Routes and towns experienced different decline, recovery and growth
- D. Only Delhi mattered
- **Answer:** C. Routes and towns experienced different decline, recovery and growth
- **Explanation:** War hurt some corridors while oceanic trade and regional centres expanded elsewhere.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Remedial MCQ 60

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Question: Which statement corrects the inevitability trap?

STATIC THEORY

- A. Mughal decline automatically caused British rule
- B. Panipat transferred sovereignty to Britain
- C. Indian rulers never defeated Company forces
- D. Fragmentation created openings, but Company victory required later revenue, credit, alliances and war
- **Answer:** D. Fragmentation created openings, but Company victory required later revenue, credit, alliances and war
- **Explanation:** Opportunity is not destiny; the sequence from commerce to fiscal-military state must be demonstrated.
- **Trap logic:** Check the category, chronology, source scale and difference between legal claim, symbolic legitimacy and practical control before selecting an option.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 10M-1 - Classify the major eighteenth-century Indian states and explain why the classification matters. (150 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century states are best classified by **origin and legitimacy**, not by a simple strong/weak scale.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Mughal successor states** - Bengal under Murshid Quli Khan, Awadh under Saadat Khan and Hyderabad under Nizam-ul-Mulk - converted provincial office into hereditary autonomy. They retained Mughal titles, Persian administration and often coin/khutba symbolism, but controlled appointments, revenue and war locally.

- **Resistance or confederate states** - Marathas, Sikhs, Jats and Rohillas - grew through armed mobilisation, local landed groups and new fiscal claims. The 1719 Maratha sanads legalised chauth/sardeshmukhi, while Banda Singh Bahadur's officials, coin and seal and the later Sikh misls reveal different routes from resistance to rule.

- **Older autonomous regional kingdoms** - Mysore, Travancore and major Rajput states - strengthened pre-existing polities. Haidar Ali's arsenal and Martanda Varma's army and pepper monopoly show more explicit centralisation.

- The classification matters because origin shaped political resources and weaknesses: successor states borrowed imperial legitimacy, confederacies traded unity for reach, and older kingdoms could innovate but still had to bargain with local elites. It therefore explains both regional vitality and the absence of one uncontested Mughal replacement.

- **Why this earns marks:** It defines the classification criterion, names three evidence-rich categories, analyses why origin mattered and avoids equating autonomy with modern nation-state sovereignty.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 10M-2 - Hyderabad represented continuity in form and autonomy in substance. Examine. (150 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Hyderabad under **Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I** illustrates how Mughal political grammar survived after imperial command weakened.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Continuity in form** remained visible in coins struck in the emperor's name, the emperor's place in the khutba, Persian chancery practice and the continued use of mansab, jagir and peshkash. These forms gave a former imperial noble recognised legitimacy among Deccan chiefs and service elites.

- **Autonomy in substance** followed the defeat of Mubariz Khan and consolidation in **1724**. Asaf Jah conducted wars and treaties, conferred mansabs and made major appointments without seeking effective approval from Delhi. Revenue served the Hyderabad treasury and army; local rulers paid tribute to the Nizam.

- Yet the state was not fully centralised. Bandyopadhyay notes that traders, moneylenders, military aristocrats and revenue farmers remained powerful; jagirs became more hereditary and power stayed widely diffused. Post-1748 succession conflict further exposed this limitation.

- Thus Hyderabad was neither a loyal province nor a modern sovereign nation-state. It was a regional patron-client order that used Mughal symbolism to legitimise practical independence.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers both halves of the formulation, uses coin/khutba and independent appointments as paired evidence, and qualifies autonomy with the state's diffused internal structure.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 10M-3 - The Third Battle of Panipat was a grave Maratha setback, not the end of Maratha power. Explain. (150 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Panipat on **14 January 1761** destroyed a major Maratha expeditionary force and sharply reduced Peshwa prestige, but it did not terminate Maratha power.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- The setback was strategic. **Sadashiv Rao Bhau**, Vishwas Rao and many experienced commanders were lost; long supply lines, factional command and damaged relations with Rajputs, Jats and Sikh chiefs left the army isolated. **Ahmad Shah Abdali**, by contrast, secured Rohilla support and Shuja-ud-Daula's alliance. The defeat therefore exposed coalition and logistics failure rather than the absence of trained infantry: **Ibrahim Khan Gardi** commanded a European-style force.

- Its limits are equally clear. Abdali did not establish durable Indian rule. Under **Madhav Rao I (1761-72)** the Marathas defeated the Nizam, pressured Haidar Ali and recovered north Indian influence. In **1771** they restored Shah Alam II to Delhi. Later Scindia power again dominated imperial politics.

- Panipat ended the immediate bid for northern paramountcy and created openings for rivals, including the Company. It did not abolish the confederacy; the decisive British-Maratha struggle still lay ahead.

- **Why this earns marks:** It separates battlefield loss, political consequence and later recovery, names commanders and the 1771 evidence, and rejects both terminal and inevitability claims.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 15M-1 - Compare state formation in Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Bengal, Awadh and Hyderabad were all Mughal successor states, but they converted provincial office into autonomy through different coalitions and regional constraints.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Common inheritance:** Each founder was an imperial servant. Murshid Quli Khan in Bengal, Saadat Khan in Awadh and Nizam-ul-Mulk in Hyderabad retained Persian administration, titles and Mughal legitimacy. None began with a modern declaration of independence. Their common mechanism was to redirect provincial revenue, appointments and military force from Delhi toward a regional treasury and dynasty.

- **Bengal - fiscal-commercial coalition:** Murshid Quli combined nazim and diwan authority in 1717, enforced revenue through large zamindars and sustained remittance. Commerce in textiles and oceanic trade elevated merchants and bankers; the **Jagat Seth** house became provincial treasurer in 1730. Alivardi Khan's rise with landed and banking support shows both strength and coalition dependence. Maratha raids and growing European privilege were the major vulnerabilities.

- **Awadh - landed-military accommodation:** Saadat Khan subdued rebellious zamindars but usually confirmed them after securing payment. A provincial fiscal establishment detached revenue from Delhi, while Indian Muslim, Afghan and Hindu elites and a rich military labour market supported the state. Safdar Jang's use of Maratha and Jat allies shows pragmatic coalition-building. Refractory chiefs remained a recurring constraint.

- **Hyderabad - patron-client Deccan order:** Asaf Jah's victory in 1724 created practical autonomy while coin and khutba retained the emperor. Local chiefs paid peshkash; traders, moneylenders, revenue farmers and military aristocrats remained co-sharers. Diffused authority and post-1748 succession conflict limited centralisation.

- Therefore the three shared Mughal institutional grammar but differed in social base: Bengal was most commercially financed, Awadh most dependent on landed-military accommodation, and Hyderabad most visibly a diffused Deccan patron-client system.

- **Why this earns marks:** It compares through common criteria - legitimacy, revenue, elite coalition and weakness - rather than narrating three states separately, and uses named institutions and bankers.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 15M-2 - Assess the Maratha polity under the Peshwas as a fiscal-military confederacy. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Under the Peshwas the Maratha polity became a far-reaching fiscal-military confederacy: its decentralisation enabled expansion but obstructed stable paramountcy.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Fiscal foundation:** The **1719 sanads** recognised Shahu's swarajya and claims to **chauth** and **sardeshmukhi** in the Deccan. Balaji Vishwanath distributed collection spheres among sardars, who retained large shares to maintain troops. This converted military initiative into recurring fiscal claims, but also made the Raja and Peshwa dependent on autonomous collectors.

- **Political centre:** **Baji Rao I (1720-40)** made the Peshwaship hereditary in practice and the focal point of patronage. Palkhed (1728) checked Nizam-ul-Mulk, while expansion into Malwa and Gujarat added resources and strategic depth. After Shahu's death in 1749, Nana Saheb shifted effective government to Poona.

- **Confederate structure:** Gaekwad, Holkar, Scindia and Bhonsle houses built personal armies and regional fiscal bases. In core areas civilian revenue officers developed more regular administration; elsewhere tribute and negotiated rights preceded direct governance. Watan and deshmukh rights survived, while saranjams rewarded service.

- **Strength:** The system mobilised cavalry and local entrepreneurship over a vast area at relatively low central cost. It adapted Mughal legal vocabulary and employed trained infantry and artillery, as shown by Ibrahim Khan Gardi.

- **Weakness:** Rival houses, uneven remittance, thin administration and poor coalition management undermined unified strategy at Panipat. Yet Madhav Rao's recovery and the restoration of Shah Alam II in 1771 show that confederacy was not simple collapse.

- The Maratha order was therefore neither a unitary empire nor mere raiding. It was an effective expansion system whose fiscal decentralisation outpaced political integration.

- **Why this earns marks:** It connects revenue measures to armies and houses, balances efficiency with strategic cost, and uses 1719, Palkhed, Panipat and 1771 as a causal sequence.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 15M-3 - Trace Sikh political transformation from the Khalsa to the misls. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Sikh political transformation in the eighteenth century was a non-linear movement from disciplined community to territorial revolt and then to decentralised confederate power.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Khalsa foundation:** In **1699**, Guru Gobind Singh established the Khalsa, using initiation and visible discipline to strengthen a distinctive armed community. After his death in 1708, authority was located in the Panth and Granth traditions rather than another personal Guru. Not all Sikhs were Khalsa, and Jat peasants, Khatri traders and other groups had different interests.

- **Banda Singh Bahadur:** Banda mobilised many Jat peasants and smaller zamindars under severe fiscal pressure. His movement crossed the line from rebellion toward state formation: he appointed faujdars, a diwan and kardars, issued orders under a seal and minted coin. Yet support was uneven. Some Jat zamindars and Khatri commercial-revenue interests sided with Mughal authority. Mughal pressure and internal division culminated in his capture in 1715 and execution in 1716.

- **Misl phase:** Sikh bands survived persecution and expanded amid the disruption caused by Nadir Shah and Ahmad Shah Abdali. Territorial gains were distributed in pattis according to contribution. The later conventional classification identifies twelve major misls, but contemporary combinations were fluid. The **Dal Khalsa** enabled collective action above individual misls without abolishing chiefly autonomy.

- **Direction of change:** The order mixed an egalitarian co-sharing ideal with the growing power of chiefs. This decentralised structure resisted Afghan control but could not produce permanent unified command. Ranjit Singh's capture of Lahore in 1799 therefore marks a later turn toward monarchy, not the starting point of Sikh politics.

- **Why this earns marks:** It traces institutions and social bases rather than a ruler list, reconciles the twelve-misl shorthand with source fluidity, and keeps Ranjit Singh within a clear boundary.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 20M-1 - Was the eighteenth century a dark age, a transition or an age of regional resurgence? Critically discuss. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

No single label fits the eighteenth century because political, economic, social and cultural change moved at different speeds and varied sharply by region.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Why "dark age" has force:** Mughal central command contracted; Nadir Shah and Abdali exposed frontier weakness; Panipat destroyed an experienced Maratha force; Bengal faced repeated Maratha raids; revenue farming and armies increased pressure on cultivators. Delhi, Lahore, Mathura, Surat and other centres suffered episodes of plunder. Older imperial histories rightly identify real war, fiscal stress and insecurity.

- **Why it is insufficient:** Regional states retained capacity. Murshid Quli Khan's Bengal maintained a powerful revenue-commercial coalition; Saadat Khan and Safdar Jang consolidated Awadh; Asaf Jah made Hyderabad autonomous; Haidar Ali built an arsenal and disciplined army; Martanda Varma combined military reform with pepper revenue and public works. Jaipur's planned city and Jantar Mantar and the shift of artists to Lucknow, Hyderabad and other courts show cultural vitality.

- **Transition in institutions:** Mughal forms survived even where Mughal control did not. Coin and khutba, Persian chancery, nazim-diwan offices, jagir, zamindar and revenue vocabulary continued, but regional rulers, bankers and local elites controlled them. Maratha chauth/sardeshmukhi, Sikh misls and Mysore's direct revenue experiments also changed the content of state power.

- **Regional resurgence with social limits:** Trade, textiles, hundi finance and oceanic commerce remained vigorous in several zones. Yet a prosperous Bengal merchant or Mysore cultivator cannot stand for all India. Peasants, artisans and women experienced outcomes according to war corridor, caste, tenure and patronage.

- **Historiography:** Materialist interpretations explain agrarian and jagirdari stress; regional and revisionist work by Muzaffar Alam, C.A. Bayly and others explains new provincial wealth and coalitions. Each is strongest at a different scale.

- The graded verdict is therefore: **crisis of imperial centralisation, transition of institutions, and selective regional resurgence under unequal social conditions.**

- **Why this earns marks:** It tests all three labels across dimensions, uses eight named regional examples, represents competing historiographies fairly and gives a scale-specific verdict rather than an artificial compromise.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 20M-2 - Examine society and economy in eighteenth-century India with attention to regional variation. (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century society and economy combined commercial resilience with fiscal coercion and durable hierarchy; regional evidence does not support either nationwide collapse or nationwide prosperity.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Agriculture and revenue:** Cultivation remained the chief revenue base. In Bengal, Awadh-Banaras and parts of the south, reclamation, monetisation and surplus supported states. Yet zamindars, jagirdars, revenue farmers and officials competed over the cultivator's surplus. War, ijara and irregular exactions could worsen insecurity even where output grew. Productivity and peasant welfare must therefore be separated.

- **Crafts and towns:** Cotton and silk textiles, saltpetre, indigo, arms, metalwork and shipbuilding remained significant. Dacca, Murshidabad, Patna, Banaras, Lucknow, Masulipatnam and southern centres continued production. Some older cities and routes suffered plunder, while new regional capitals such as Lucknow, Poona, Jaipur and Hyderabad attracted artisans and officials. Urban change was redistribution, not a single decline curve.

- **Trade and finance:** European companies imported bullion for Indian goods and expanded oceanic commerce, while Hindu, Muslim and Armenian merchants remained important. The Jagat Seth house linked Bengal's treasury, mint and remittance; hundis moved credit across regions. But European fortified factories and privilege gave commerce an increasingly coercive political edge.

- **Social structure:** Zamindars ranged from local intermediaries to rajas; peasants were differentiated by rights and resources. Caste remained strong, though military and fiscal service enabled mobility, as the Holkar rise shows. Muslim society also had status, sect and occupational hierarchy. Tarabai and Ahilyabai reveal elite female agency, while peasant women worked in fields and crafts; neither evidence justifies a uniform gender claim.

- **Culture and community:** Cross-religious service and shared Persianate-vernacular worlds continued, but "composite culture" did not erase caste or elite control.

- Thus the economy was regionally resilient and socially unequal: state formation created markets and careers while often transferring its fiscal cost downward.

- **Why this earns marks:** It integrates agriculture, crafts, finance, towns, caste and gender; names regional evidence; and repeatedly qualifies aggregate claims and source visibility.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

Mains 20M-3 - How did eighteenth-century state formation prepare the ground for Company expansion without making conquest inevitable? (250 words)

GS-I Modern
Indian History

INTRO & ORIGIN

Eighteenth-century state formation created a competitive fiscal-military field into which European companies could enter, but Company conquest required later, contingent advantages.

STATIC THEORY

- Model answer

- **Openings created by regional politics:** Succession disputes in Hyderabad and the Carnatic allowed French and English companies to sell troops and install clients. Bengal's Nawabs confronted fortified factories and the abuse of the 1717 trade privilege. Maratha, Awadh, Rohilla and Rajput rivalries produced repeated alliance markets. Mobile sepoys, gunners and commanders and Indian bankers made military intervention possible.

- **Financial connection:** Regional states depended on credit, remittance and revenue contractors. The Jagat Seths in Bengal and hundi networks demonstrate the centrality of finance. Companies entered this world as merchants and creditors, then combined contracts with armed force.

- **Company differentiation:** Its later advantage was cumulative integration: unified command, regular payment, artillery-infantry drill, coastal supply, British naval protection, London and Indian credit, and diplomacy that isolated opponents. After Plassey and especially the **Diwani of 1765**, Bengal revenue financed purchases and new wars, turning a company into a territorial fiscal-military state.

- **Why defeat was not predetermined:** Indian states adapted. Haidar Ali created a modern arsenal and defeated Company forces; the Second Anglo-Mysore War ended at the Treaty of Mangalore. The First Anglo-Maratha War ended in the negotiated Treaty of Salbai, and Punjab remained independent under Ranjit Singh. Panipat did not transfer India to Britain.

- **Structural weakness without teleology:** Confederacies faced coordination problems, successor states depended on elite coalitions, and no stable all-India alliance emerged. Yet these were vulnerabilities, not a timetable for conquest.

- Therefore regionalisation supplied opportunities and Indian resources, while British supremacy resulted from specific victories, Bengal finance, corporate-state organisation and Indian collaboration. The bridge was real; inevitability was not.

- **Why this earns marks:** It answers both the enabling and anti-inevitability halves, names succession, banking, Diwani and Indian counter-successes, and explains mechanism rather than moralising about unity.

MAINS ANGLE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

STUDY LINK

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

REGISTER 01 - Scope and debate

GS-I Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- Core field: c.1707 to early 1800s; Shivaji/Khalsa are bounded legacies and Company conquest is a bounded consequence.

- Governing line: central Mughal decline + regional state formation + institutional continuity + uneven economic/social outcomes.

- Crisis best fits imperial command and war corridors; transition fits institutions; regional resurgence fits selected states, markets and courts.

- Never infer all-India prosperity from Bengal or all-India collapse from Delhi.

- Answer opener: "The eighteenth century changed the location and coalition of power more uniformly than it changed social welfare."

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

REGISTER 02 - SourcesGS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Persian chronicles: offices, factions and campaigns; elite/moralising limit.
- Farman/sanad: legal claim, not proof of implementation.
- Coin/khutba/seal: symbolic sovereignty; pair with revenue, appointments and war.
- Revenue/banking records: fiscal capacity, hundi, ijara, mint and surety; uneven survival.
- Company records: precise on goods/privilege, corporate bias.
- Regional traditions: mobilisation and memory, retrospective legitimisation.
- Material heritage: forts, observatories, paintings and coins show capacity/patronage, not a complete polity.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

REGISTER 03 - HyderabadGS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Founder: Nizam-ul-Mulk Asaf Jah I; conventional autonomy date 1724 after defeating Mubariz Khan.
- Continuity: emperor on coin/khutba; Persian, mansab, jagir and peshkash vocabulary.
- Autonomy: wars, treaties, appointments and mansabs made locally.
- Coalition: local chiefs, traders, moneylenders, military aristocrats and revenue farmers.
- Change: jagirs more hereditary; Mughal forms retained but regulatory content weakened.
- Limit: power widely diffused; succession conflict after 1748.
- One-line verdict: formal hierarchy survived while regional command shifted to Hyderabad.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

REGISTER 04 - BengalGS-I Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- Murshid Quli Khan: nazim + diwan in 1717; survey, punctual revenue, larger zamindars.
- Shuja-ud-din: dynastic succession with imperial endorsement.
- Alivardi Khan, 1740-56: local appointments, practical autonomy, Afghan and Maratha challenges.
- Jagat Seth: provincial treasury/mint/remittance link; Umi Chand and Khoja Wajid show merchant scale.
- Economy: textiles, bullion and oceanic trade; overland disruption under Maratha raids.
- 1751: Orissa/chauth settlement; avoid damage totals.
- Boundary: stop at Siraj's 1756 accession; Plassey/Buxar/Diwani belong Topic 04.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 05 - Awadh**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Saadat Khan appointed 1722; title Burhan-ul-Mulk; fresh revenue settlement.
- Zamindars subdued but usually confirmed after agreeing to pay: controlled accommodation.
- Fiscal establishment detached from effective Delhi supervision; local gentry and mixed elite coalition.
- Safdar Jang: successor, imperial wazir from 1748, used Maratha and Jat aid against Afghan rivals.
- Strategic base: fertile middle Ganga plain, trade, mobile military labour.
- Limit: refractory chiefs and later Company pressure; no direct peasant-welfare generalisation.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 06 - Marathas**GS-I Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- Legacy: Shivaji's forts/revenue/coronation bounded; post-1707 Shahu versus Tarabai.
- Peshwa line: Balaji Vishwanath -> Baji Rao I -> Nana Saheb -> Madhav Rao I.
- 1719: Mughal sanads recognise swarajya and Deccan chauth/sardeshmukhi with obligations.
- Palkhed 1728; Malwa/Gujarat expansion; Poona effective centre after Shahu, 1749.
- Houses: Gaekwad, Holkar, Scindia, Bhonsle; personal armies and fiscal bases.
- Chauth = one-fourth claim; sardeshmukhi = additional one-tenth; neither automatically means direct rule.
- Panipat 1761 = grave setback; recovery shown by Shah Alam II's restoration in 1771.
- Trap: confederacy, not homogeneous modern nation or mere raiding force.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 07 - Sikhs**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- 1699 Khalsa: initiation, visible discipline and armed identity; not all Sikhs immediately Khalsa.
- Guru Gobind Singh dies 1708; authority in Panth/Granth traditions.
- Banda: Jat peasant/small-zamindar support; faujdars, diwan, kardars, coin and seal; captured 1715, executed 1716.
- Social caution: Khatri and Jat interests varied; no unanimous bloc.
- Misls: territorial shares/pattis; twelve major misls is a conventional classification, not timeless exactness.
- Dal Khalsa: collective action above misls, without permanent unitary command.
- Ranjit Singh captures Lahore 1799: bounded transition to monarchy, not starting point.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 08 - Mysore and Travancore**GS-I Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- Mysore genealogy: post-Vijayanagara Wodeyar kingdom; not a Mughal successor.
- Haidar: Dindigul arsenal 1755, effective control 1761, French-trained infantry/artillery, poligar control.
- Military fiscalism: survey/cash revenue -> central army; intermediary reduction selective, not total.
- Tipu bounded: stronger coin/khutba sovereignty, state trade and wars belong later.
- Travancore: Martanda Varma after 1729; army reform, feudatory suppression, Dutch check, pepper monopoly, roads/canals.
- Comparison: both centralised; Mysore more land-army oriented, Travancore more coastal-trade oriented.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 09 - Other states**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Jats: Churaman/Badan Singh -> Suraj Mal (1756-63); peasant-zamindar origin but hierarchical state.
- Suraj Mal used Mughal-style revenue and reduced some kinsmen; state declined after him.
- Rajputs: autonomy plus clan rivalry; no united nationalist bloc.
- Sawai Jai Singh II: Jaipur 1727, observatories and Zij; scientific vitality with court limit.
- Rohilkhand: Ali Muhammad Khan and Afghan military settlement; not created by Durrani.
- Farrukhabad: Ahmad Khan Bangash.
- Arcot/Carnatic: emerged from Hyderabad-Deccan hierarchy; European succession intervention belongs Topic 03.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 10 - Fiscal-military systems**GS-I Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- Formula: revenue + credit -> army/supply -> coercion/protection -> new revenue.
- Ijara: collection farmed to highest/contracted bidder; quick cash, extraction risk.
- Peshkash: tribute acknowledging superior authority.
- Hundi: mobile credit/remittance instrument.
- Military labour: Afghans, Rajputs, Marathas, infantry, gunners and Europeans moved among courts.
- Indian adaptation: Mysore arsenal, Ibrahim Khan Gardi, later Sikh modernisation.
- Company distinction later: integrated command + maritime supply + corporate/Indian credit + Bengal revenue.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 11 - Society****GS-I** Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Ruling elites varied; austerity and luxury both existed - reject universal moral decadence.
- Zamindars/deshmukhs/poligars: revenue, fort, arms and community authority; scale varied.
- Peasants: differentiated by rights/resources; could support state, zamindar or revolt.
- Caste and status remained strong; service enabled selective mobility (Holkar).
- Muslim society also stratified by lineage, sect, occupation and status.
- Women: Tarabai/Ahilyabai elite agency; peasant/craft labour; purdah, sati and widow rules varied.
- Source limit: elite women and spectacular customs are over-recorded.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 12 - Economy and merchants****GS-I** Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- Agriculture remained revenue base; output growth can coexist with worsening welfare.
- Regional surplus: Bengal, Awadh-Banaras, selected southern zones; no national aggregate.
- Crafts: cotton/silk textiles, saltpetre, indigo, arms, metalwork, shipbuilding.
- Urban redistribution: some old centres plundered; Murshidabad, Lucknow, Poona, Jaipur, Hyderabad gained.
- Bankers: Jagat Seth; surety, treasury, mint, remittance and political leverage.
- Trade: inland routes uneven; oceanic European bullion/demand expanded.
- Triangle: banker <-> state <-> company; alignment followed security and repayment, not fixed loyalty.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 13 - Culture**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Patronage shifted from exclusive Delhi dominance to regional courts.
- Languages: Persian administration plus Urdu, Marathi, Punjabi, Bengali, Braj and Malayalam worlds.
- Centres: Lucknow handicrafts/literature; Hyderabad/Arcot Deccani culture; Travancore scholarship; Jaipur astronomy/planning.
- Painting/music moved and regionalised; court vitality does not equal mass welfare.
- Composite culture: cross-religious service and shared practices; qualify with caste, sect and elite literacy.
- Heritage: UNESCO Maratha forts and Jantar Mantar, Gobindgarh restoration; material survival, not total historical proof.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 14 - Continuity and innovation**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Continuity: subah, nazim, diwan, mansab, jagir, Persian chancery, coin, khutba, zamindar mediation.
- Innovation: Bengal office concentration; Hyderabad patron-client change; Maratha confederate fiscal spheres; misl shares; Mysore direct revenue.
- Core distinction: same institutional name can carry changed content.
- Symbolism test: coin/khutba = legitimacy; appointments/revenue/war = practical autonomy.
- Best phrase: "continuity of grammar, change of authorship."

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 15 - Colonial bridge**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Openings: succession disputes, interstate rivalry, bankers, mobile troops and fortified factories.
- Companies entered as merchants, creditors and military contractors inside Indian politics.
- Turning sequence: Carnatic intervention -> Plassey 1757 -> Buxar 1764 -> Diwani 1765.
- Company edge: unified command, regular pay, naval/coastal supply, credit and territorial revenue.
- Anti-inevitability: Haidar's victories/Mangalore; Salbai; Ranjit Singh's independence; Maratha recovery.
- Verdict: regionalisation created opportunity; conquest required later contingent victories and Indian collaboration.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH**REGISTER 16 - Historiography and source limits**GS-I Modern
Indian History**TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS**

- Dark-age/imperial: central crisis, invasion, faction; overgeneralises and may moralise.
- Aligarh/materialist: Irfan Habib and Satish Chandra - jagirdari/agrarian/fiscal contradiction; regional variation caveat.
- Regional/Cambridge-inflected: C.A. Bayly, Muzaffar Alam and regional studies - local elites, portfolio capital, networks; coercion caveat.
- Economic revision: trade/credit/production resilience in selected zones; no all-India golden age.
- Scale rule: Delhi chronicle, provincial account and village evidence answer different questions.
- Final line: crisis of centre + regional state formation + uneven social cost.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

HIGH

REGISTER 17 - PYQ spine

GS-I Modern
Indian History

TOPIC-SPECIFIC REGISTER POINTS

- 2021 Prelims Q48: Arcot from Hyderabad = correct; Mysore from Vijayanagara = correct; Rohilkhand from Durrani territory = incorrect. Inferred B; official local key unavailable.
- 2021 Prelims Q45: ascending unit = pargana -> sarkar -> subah. Inferred A; official local key unavailable.
- 2022 GS-I Q2: Company armies won through command, credit, supply, alliance and later Bengal revenue - not ethnicity.
- 10M route: thesis + three named states/events + qualification.
- 15M route: common criteria comparison - legitimacy, revenue, coalition, military and weakness.
- 20M route: typology -> fiscal-military/social/economic evidence -> regional variation -> historiography -> colonial bridge -> graded verdict.
- Universal spine: claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation -> conclusion.

PYQ AND ANSWER ROUTE

Use claim -> named evidence -> significance -> limitation; maintain regional and source discipline.

REVISION BRIDGE

Modern History Topics 01, 03, 04 and 05;
Medieval History Topics 23-25.

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI